The Social Democratic Market Platform

Version 1.1

Gregory L. Meyers

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The Social Democratic Market Platform

A Governing Blueprint for Shared Prosperity, Competitive Markets, Democratic Accountability, Scientific Advancement, and National Resilience

Version 1.1 — Consistency Edition

Gregory L. Meyers

Publication Date: November 2026

Government provides the foundation. Citizens provide the ambition. Markets provide the growth.

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Public Release Version 1.1

AUTHOR'S NOTE

The Social Democratic Market Platform was developed by Gregory L. Meyers through an iterative process of research, analysis, drafting, review, and revision.

Various software tools, including artificial intelligence-assisted drafting, editing, and research-support tools, were used during portions of the development process to improve organization, clarity, and presentation. All policy positions, structural decisions, classifications, revisions, and final content reflect the judgment, review, and approval of the author.

This document represents the author's policy recommendations and governing philosophy. Its purpose is to provide a comprehensive framework for public discussion concerning economic opportunity, democratic accountability, competitive markets, scientific progress, fiscal responsibility, and long-term national resilience.

Version: 1.1

Publication Date: November 2026

Author: Gregory L. Meyers

DOCUMENT INFORMATION

Title: The Social Democratic Market Platform

Subtitle: A Governing Blueprint for Shared Prosperity, Competitive Markets, Democratic Accountability, Scientific Advancement, and National Resilience

Version: 1.1

Author: Gregory L. Meyers

Publication Date: November 2026

Document Purpose: Public Policy Platform and Governing Framework

Status: Second Public Release (Consistency Edition)

Version History

Version 1.0 | November 2026

Initial Public Release

Version 1.1 | November 2026

Consistency Edition. Resolves the contradictions found in the v1.0 audit: one authoritative financing chapter (Chapter 27) with a single use for every revenue stream; Social Security, Universal Health Insurance and frontier AI chapters aligned with their white papers; independent bodies redesigned for *Trump v. Slaughter* (2026); carbon fee revenue split 80/10/10; reorganized into nine Parts and 27 chapters (see Appendix D for the old-to-new section map). See CHANGELOG.md for the full list.

Platform Overview

Government provides the foundation. Citizens provide the ambition. Markets provide the growth.

The Social Democratic Market Platform rejects the choice between centralized economic control and unrestricted markets. Government guarantees a strong public foundation: healthcare, education, infrastructure, public safety, democratic institutions, and equal opportunity. On that foundation, competitive markets remain the primary engine of innovation, investment, and prosperity.

Three Core Goals

Guarantee every American a baseline of economic security and genuine opportunity.

Preserve competitive markets, entrepreneurship, private property, and free enterprise as the primary engines of innovation, growth, and wealth creation.

Use government intervention only where markets systematically fail to provide efficient, fair, or broadly accessible outcomes.

How the Platform Is Organized

Part

What it covers

I. Economic Foundations

Rules-based recession response, federal tax fairness including the Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax, a living wage, paid leave and care, and the safety net

II. Human Development

Universal Health Insurance, reproductive health protection, education from preschool through tuition-free public college, and housing

III. Competitive Markets

Anti-monopoly enforcement and consumer rights, family farms, and trade with strategic protection

IV. Democracy, Governance & Public Trust

Election reform, civil rights, effective government, and ethics

V. Justice, Public Safety & Immigration

Violent-crime priority, rehabilitation, accountability, and a secure, orderly, humane immigration system

VI. Science & Technology

Research and space leadership, and capability-based frontier AI governance

VII. Climate, Infrastructure & Resilience

A carbon fee with household dividends, clean-energy buildout, infrastructure and supply chains, and disaster resilience

VIII. Security & Global Leadership

Diplomacy first, strong alliances, a capable defensive military, and voluntary national service

IX. Long-Term Sustainability

Social Security without benefit cuts, and the Master Financing Framework

How It Is Paid For

Every revenue stream is assigned to exactly one use, so no dollar is counted twice, and recurring programs draw only on stable revenue (Chapter 27). No major program takes effect without an independent cost estimate and its assigned revenue. Dollar estimates are not yet included in this edition.

How to Read It

Each provision carries a legal classification (see Legal Classifications), and the most difficult provisions include an *honest limit* stating their main legal or political risk. Where the platform and a white paper differ, the white paper governs. A full Executive Summary is published separately.

Build the foundation. Expand opportunity. Strengthen democracy. Invest in the future. Empower the people.

Legal Classifications

[Statute] Federal legislation requiring a standard congressional majority.

[Statute – High Resistance] Legislation facing substantial political, legal, economic, or administrative barriers.

[Executive] Achievable through executive authority.

[Constitutional Amendment] Requires constitutional ratification.

Constitutionally Contested A flag added to a classification when serious constitutional objections are likely. Each such provision includes an honest-limit note.

Governing Principles of the Social Democratic Market Platform

Purpose

The policies contained within this platform are organized around a unified governing philosophy rather than a collection of isolated proposals. These principles provide the framework through which all statutes, regulations, investments, and reforms should be interpreted and implemented.

Whenever ambiguity exists, policymakers should seek outcomes that best advance these principles as a whole.

Core Values

Principle 1: Human Dignity

Every person possesses inherent worth and deserves to be treated with dignity, fairness, and respect.

Public institutions should safeguard individual rights, ensure due process, and maintain equal treatment under the law regardless of income, race, religion, sex, disability, age, political affiliation, or citizenship status, while recognizing that eligibility for some benefits, such as full public health insurance under Section 5.1, depends on lawful residence.

Economic policy exists to serve people, not the other way around.

Principle 2: Equal Opportunity

Opportunity should not be determined by the circumstances of birth.

Every person should have access to the foundational systems necessary to pursue success, including:

- Healthcare
- Education
- Public safety
- Infrastructure
- Communications

- Housing opportunity

Government cannot guarantee outcomes, but it can and should guarantee access to opportunity.

Principle 3: Democratic Accountability

Government derives its legitimacy from the consent of the governed.

Public institutions must remain:

- Transparent
- Accountable
- Ethical
- Accessible
- Responsive

Public office is a public trust and shall never be used for private enrichment.

Citizens must retain the ability to monitor, challenge, and reform their government through democratic institutions.

Governing Principles

Principle 4: Competitive Markets

Free and competitive markets remain the most effective engine for innovation, investment, productivity, and wealth creation.

Government should preserve competition rather than replace markets.

Public policy should:

- Prevent monopoly power
- Protect consumer choice
- Encourage entrepreneurship
- Remove unnecessary barriers to entry
- Reward innovation and productivity

Success should come through value creation rather than political favoritism or market dominance.

Principle 5: Scientific Evidence

Sound public policy should be guided by evidence, measurable outcomes, and empirical research.

Programs should be evaluated according to effectiveness rather than ideology.

Scientific inquiry, academic freedom, and the pursuit of knowledge strengthen both democracy and economic prosperity.

Good ideas should survive scrutiny. Failed ideas should be revised regardless of political origin.

Principle 6: Fiscal Responsibility

Future generations should not inherit unsustainable obligations created by present-day decisions.

Public investments should be financed responsibly, evaluated honestly, and implemented transparently.

Borrowing may be justified when creating long-term productive assets, but recurring obligations should be matched with sustainable revenue sources whenever practical.

Fiscal responsibility is not an alternative to public investment. It is a requirement for lasting public investment.

Long-Term Responsibilities

Principle 7: National Resilience

A prosperous nation must be capable of preparing for, responding to, and recovering from major disruptions.

National resilience includes:

- Economic stability
- Public health preparedness
- Infrastructure reliability
- Energy security
- Supply-chain resilience
- Disaster readiness
- Cybersecurity
- Democratic continuity

Short-term efficiency should never undermine long-term national security or stability.

Principle 8: Stewardship of Future Generations

Each generation holds a temporary responsibility for institutions, infrastructure, resources, and freedoms that will be inherited by those who follow.

Public policy should consider not only immediate benefits, but also long-term consequences.

Investments in education, science, infrastructure, environmental stewardship, and democratic institutions are investments in future generations.

Principle 9: Civic Responsibility

Freedom is strengthened when citizens actively participate in their communities and democratic institutions.

A healthy society depends upon citizens who:

- Vote
- Volunteer
- Serve their communities
- Respect democratic processes
- Contribute to the common good

Government can create opportunity, but strong communities are built by engaged citizens.

Principle 10: The Public Foundation

The central organizing principle of this platform is the belief that government should provide a strong public foundation upon which individuals, families, communities, and businesses can thrive.

That foundation includes:

- Healthcare
- Education
- Infrastructure
- Public safety
- Democratic institutions
- Scientific research
- Equal opportunity

Once this foundation exists, citizens remain free to pursue their own goals, build wealth, create businesses, innovate, and shape their futures.

Final Clause

In the event of conflict between competing policy objectives, policymakers should seek solutions that best advance these ten principles as a whole.

These principles express the platform's philosophy. For the legal interpretation of statutes, the Statutory Interpretation Principle in the Definitions governs.

The Social Democratic Market Compact

This platform is founded on a simple belief:

Government provides the foundation. Citizens provide the ambition. Markets provide the growth.

Government shall guarantee the essential foundations of opportunity.

Citizens shall remain free to pursue success according to their own talents, goals, and aspirations.

Competitive markets shall serve as the primary engine of innovation, investment, and prosperity.

Together, these principles form the Social Democratic Market Model and provide the framework for every policy contained within this platform.

Definitions

The following definitions shall apply throughout The Social Democratic Market Platform unless otherwise specified by statute, constitutional amendment, or implementing legislation.

Living Wage

A Living Wage is the minimum hourly compensation necessary for a full-time worker to meet basic living expenses within a specific geographic area without requiring public assistance for ordinary necessities.

The calculation shall consider:

- **Housing**
- **Food**
- **Transportation**
- **Healthcare**
- **Childcare**
- **Utilities**
- **Basic communication services**
- **Essential savings**

A Living Wage may vary by region to reflect differences in local costs of living.

The Living Wage serves as the benchmark used to set the percentage of the federal poverty line in Section 3.1.

Costs met by universal public programs established in this platform (such as public health insurance, preschool, and capped childcare) shall be excluded from the calculation to avoid double-counting.

Productive Capital Expenditure

A Productive Capital Expenditure is an investment that increases long-term economic output, productive capacity, workforce capability, infrastructure quality, or scientific advancement.

Examples include:

- **Manufacturing expansion**
- **Research and development**
- **Workforce training**
- **Infrastructure construction**
- **Technology upgrades**
- **Equipment modernization**

Productive Capital Expenditures shall be distinguished from purely speculative or consumptive expenditures.

Critical Emergency Supplies

Critical Emergency Supplies are goods necessary to maintain public safety, public health, or national resilience during emergencies.

These may include:

- **Medical equipment**
- **Essential pharmaceuticals**
- **Protective equipment**
- **Emergency communications systems**
- **Water-treatment materials**
- **Energy-related emergency components**
- **Disaster-response equipment**

The federal government may designate additional categories when justified by national risk assessments.

Frontier AI System

A Frontier AI System is an artificial intelligence model or collection of models demonstrating capabilities sufficiently advanced to create substantial economic, societal, cybersecurity, national-security, or public-safety consequences.

Determinations shall rest primarily on demonstrated performance, assessed under the Algorithmic Capability Index, with training compute serving as a screening trigger (Section 19.2.1).

Autonomous AI Action

An Autonomous AI Action is a decision, activity, process, or sequence of operations performed by an artificial intelligence system without direct human approval for each individual action at the time the action occurs.

Examples may include:

- **Independent cybersecurity operations**
- **Resource allocation decisions**
- **Multi-step task execution**
- **Software deployment**
- **Financial transactions**

Routine automated functions with clearly constrained authority may receive separate regulatory treatment.

Strategic Industry

A Strategic Industry is an economic sector whose disruption would significantly affect national security, economic stability, public health, or critical infrastructure.

Strategic industries may include:

- **Semiconductors**
- **Pharmaceuticals**
- **Biotechnology**
- **Aerospace**
- **Energy production**
- **Advanced manufacturing**
- **Communications infrastructure**
- **Critical mineral production**

Congress may periodically revise this designation.

Human Dignity Standard

The Human Dignity Standard requires that individuals interacting with public institutions be treated with fairness, respect, due process, and recognition of their inherent worth regardless of citizenship status, income level, race, religion, disability, age, sex, or political affiliation.

This standard applies throughout:

- **Healthcare systems**
- **Criminal justice systems**
- **Immigration systems**
- **Public-benefit administration**
- **Government services**

Addiction Hotspot

An Addiction Hotspot is a geographic area experiencing unusually high rates of:

- **Substance dependency**
- **Drug overdoses**
- **Addiction-related hospitalizations**
- **Addiction-related criminal activity**

Designation may qualify a community for targeted prevention, treatment, and recovery resources.

Beneficial Ownership

Beneficial Ownership refers to the natural person or persons who ultimately control, profit from, or possess economic interest in an asset, corporation, trust, partnership, or other legal entity, regardless of intermediary ownership structures.

Beneficial ownership disclosure requirements shall be used to reduce:

- **Tax evasion**
- **Money laundering**
- **Fraud**
- **Concealed political influence**
- **Illicit financial activity**

National Resilience

National Resilience is the ability of the United States to prepare for, withstand, respond to, recover from, and adapt to disruptive events while maintaining essential societal functions.

National resilience encompasses:

- **Economic resilience**
- **Infrastructure resilience**
- **Disaster preparedness**
- **Public-health readiness**
- **Supply-chain security**
- **Cybersecurity**
- **Energy reliability**
- **Democratic continuity**

Competitive Market

A Competitive Market is a market characterized by:

- **Multiple sellers**
- **Consumer choice**
- **Relatively low barriers to entry**
- **Transparent information**
- **Fair competition**

Competition should occur on the basis of:

- **Innovation**
- **Quality**
- **Efficiency**
- **Service**

rather than anti-competitive conduct or regulatory favoritism.

Family Farm

A Family Farm is an agricultural business primarily owned, managed, and operated by an individual, family, or family-controlled entity rather than by a publicly traded corporation, foreign government, or large institutional investment group.

Evidence-Based Governance

Evidence-Based Governance is the practice of designing, evaluating, and modifying public policy according to measurable outcomes, empirical evidence, scientific research, and transparent performance metrics rather than ideological preference alone.

Programs should be evaluated according to:

- **Effectiveness**
- **Efficiency**
- **Cost-benefit performance**
- **Public outcomes**
- **Long-term sustainability**

Public Foundation

The Public Foundation refers collectively to the core public systems necessary for opportunity and long-term prosperity, including:

- **Healthcare**
- **Education**
- **Infrastructure**
- **Public safety**
- **Democratic institutions**
- **Scientific research**
- **Environmental stewardship**
- **Equal opportunity protections**

The Public Foundation is the central organizing principle of this platform.

Sovereign Wealth Reserve

The Sovereign Wealth Reserve is a publicly owned investment fund designed to:

- **Stabilize economic cycles**
- **Hold Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax revenue up to a statutory stabilization target**
- **Strengthen fiscal resilience**

Assets shall be professionally managed under transparent and independent governance structures. The Reserve exists solely for recession stabilization. No other program may claim it (Section 27.5).

Dominance Threshold

A firm meets the Dominance Threshold in a market when it holds a durable share of that market and is protected by barriers to entry that prevent effective competition, as specified in statute and in rules issued by the enforcing agencies. Size alone shall never trigger intervention. Duties that apply above the threshold target conduct. Used in Sections 8.1.3, 9.2, and 10.1.5.

Strategic Protection Test

A trade restriction, sourcing requirement, or domestic-production preference meets the Strategic Protection Test only if it (1) addresses a documented national-security or resilience need identified under Section 21.6, (2) has an estimated and capped cost to consumers and businesses, (3) carries a sunset and review date, and (4) in the case of a tariff, rests on authority expressly granted by Congress. Used in Sections 11.2, 21.6.1, 21.8, and 24.3.

Coordinated Review Standard

Faster permitting shall come from funded staff, coordinated agency review, and clear timelines, never from narrowing environmental or safety review or limiting public participation (Section 21.9).

Capital Investment and Recurring Obligation

A capital investment creates a long-lived productive asset, such as infrastructure or research facilities. A recurring obligation is an ongoing program cost. Recurring obligations shall be paid only from stable revenue (Chapter 27).

Hosted and Open-Weight Models

A hosted model runs on infrastructure its developer controls and can be suspended. An open-weight model's parameters have been publicly released and cannot be recalled (Chapter 19).

Statutory Interpretation Principle

When ambiguity in the platform's statutory provisions must be resolved, interpretation should favor the following Governing Principles, in this order:

1. **Democratic accountability.**
2. **Human dignity.**
3. **Competitive markets.**
4. **Scientific evidence.**
5. **Long-term national resilience.**

6. **Equal opportunity.**

7. **Fiscal responsibility.**

The full statement of each principle appears in the Governing Principles.

No major program in this platform shall take effect without an identified funding source and an independent cost estimate under Chapter 27.

PART I: ECONOMIC FOUNDATIONS

Chapter 1: Macroeconomic Stability

1.1 Steady Economic Growth [Statute]

The central bank shall maintain a stable nominal GDP growth target of approximately 4-5 percent annually to reduce recession severity and maintain employment stability.

1.2 Recession Emergency Valve [Statute]

Baseline federal spending shall be capped relative to the size of the economy. The cap shall be suspended automatically, within the first quarter of a downturn, when a rules-based recession indicator (such as an early-warning unemployment trigger of the Sahm Rule type) is met and core inflation is at or below a defined target threshold. The inflation threshold prevents fiscal stimulus from compounding a supply-shock or stagflationary crisis. The cap shall return only after a sustained, multi-quarter confirmation of economic recovery, so that spending is not withdrawn prematurely. Outside a downturn, the cap may rise only by the independently scored revenue that a newly enacted program brings with it (Section 27.6).

1.3 Sovereign Wealth Reserve [Statute]

A protected sovereign reserve fund shall exist solely to stabilize the economy during recessions. It shall be funded by Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax revenue (Section 2.1) up to a stabilization target fixed in statute, drawn only when the recession trigger in Section 1.2 is met, and refilled after recovery. Revenue above the target shall go to a Capital Investment Account for one-time capital projects only. No other program, fund, or endowment may claim the Reserve. Full rules are in Section 27.5.

Chapter 2: Federal Tax Fairness

2.1 Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax [Statute – High Resistance]

A tax shall apply to wealth above an inflation-indexed threshold of $50 million, in marginal brackets rather than a single cliff, excluding primary residences, retirement accounts, and ordinary small businesses. The tax shall be designed as closely as possible to a tax on gains, to reduce constitutional risk under the Direct Tax Clause.

- Publicly traded assets: unrealized gains shall be taxed annually using daily market closing prices.

- Illiquid assets (private companies and closely held businesses): taxed at realization.
- Loans and synthetic liquidity: any large loan collateralized by covered assets, and any transaction that provides liquidity referencing an asset's value without a taxable sale (including prepaid variable forward contracts, equity collars, and swaps), shall count as a realization event. This broadens the constructive-sale precedent in Internal Revenue Code Section 1259.

Implementation note: because this rule is written broadly on purpose, expect multi-year litigation over the boundary between legitimate hedging and taxable liquidity extraction.

2.1.1 Enhanced Anti-Evasion Framework [Statute]

Mandatory beneficial ownership reporting, asset aggregation requirements, global disclosure standards, concealment penalties, and strengthened exit-tax provisions shall prevent avoidance schemes. Aggregation rules shall cover trusts, family entities, and minor children.

2.2 Liquidity Smoothing Mechanism [Statute]

Covered taxpayers may satisfy certain obligations through transfers of non-voting equity. Equity received shall be held in a separate passive account, shall carry no government voting or control rights, shall not count toward the Sovereign Wealth Reserve's recession-stabilization balance, and shall be sold down on a defined schedule.

2.3 Productive Capital Exemption [Statute]

Borrowing against business equity is exempt from the realization rule in Section 2.1 only when the proceeds are contributed directly to the operating business and used for productive capital expenditure (such as payroll growth, infrastructure, manufacturing expansion, or research and development), verified through audited tracing of funds. Loan proceeds used for personal consumption, owner distributions, or the purchase of unrelated assets are realization events. The exemption shall be capped as a share of the borrower's covered wealth to prevent abuse.

2.4 Targeted IRS Audits [Statute]

A dedicated High-Net-Worth and Complex-Entity Enforcement Division shall be statutorily ring-fenced. Its funding shall be restricted by appropriations rider to audits of filers above the Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax threshold and of large or complex corporate and partnership structures and shall not be used to audit ordinary filers. The IRS shall publicly report audit rates by income and wealth bracket, and the division shall be reauthorized every five years based on performance data.

2.5 State Tax Progressivity Incentive [Statute]

Federal incentives shall encourage states to move toward more progressive taxation and away from highly regressive sales tax dependence.

Chapter 3: Work, Wages & Family

3.1 Living Wage Framework [Statute]

The federal minimum wage shall be set as a fixed percentage of the federal poverty line and adjusted for regional cost of living using federal regional price data. To avoid sharp differences across metropolitan boundaries, the regional adjustment shall phase in gradually across a buffer zone (a linear taper over a defined distance) rather than changing at the boundary line.

3.2 Protecting the Right to Unionize [Statute]

Workers shall have strong protections against retaliation and unfair labor practices, including faster union election timelines, limits on mandatory anti-union meetings, and meaningful penalties for illegal retaliation. Bargaining shall remain decentralized and voluntary at the firm level.

3.3 Paid Leave Framework [Statute]

All workers shall have access to paid family, parental, caregiving, and personal medical leave regardless of employer size, for up to 12 weeks per year. Wage replacement shall be funded by federal funds and administered as a social-insurance pool so that no single employer bears the full cost of a worker's leave. Job-protection requirements may be phased in for the smallest employers, but wage replacement shall be available to all workers.

3.4 Care Economy Infrastructure [Statute – High Resistance]

Childcare from birth to school entry shall have costs capped on a sliding scale relative to household income, with the cap phasing in smoothly rather than ending at an income cliff.

Public funds shall support provider pay, workforce training, and facility capacity so that affordable care is actually available, particularly for infants and in rural areas.

Eldercare costs shall likewise be capped on a sliding scale, and long-term care shall be addressed through the public insurance system under Section 5.1, with support for family caregivers.

3.5 Workforce Mobility & Occupational Licensing Reform [Statute]

Occupational licensing shall exist only where justified by public safety.

3.5.1 Interstate License Recognition

Workers licensed in one state should generally be able to practice in another without repeating equivalent qualification requirements.

3.5.2 Apprenticeship Expansion

Earn-while-you-learn career pathways shall be expanded through federal partnerships.

3.5.3 Military Credential Recognition

Military certifications and experience shall receive expedited civilian recognition.

Chapter 4: Income Security & the Safety Net

4.1 Welfare Cliff Reform [Statute]

Benefit phase-outs shall occur gradually so additional work always increases net household income.

PART II: HUMAN DEVELOPMENT

A prosperous society is built not only through economic growth, but through investments in people. Healthcare, education, housing, communications infrastructure, and consumer rights form the foundation upon which individuals and families build successful lives.

The purpose of public investment is not to eliminate private markets. The purpose is to ensure every citizen has access to the essential systems required to participate fully in society and the economy.

Chapter 5: Universal Health Insurance

5.1 Universal Health Insurance [Statute – High Resistance]

Aligned with the white paper Universal Health Insurance: A Hybrid Framework for Universal Coverage *(decision 0001).*

The United States shall establish a national public health insurance system providing universal coverage for all citizens, lawful permanent residents, and other lawfully present residents. Emergency care, treatment of communicable disease, and public-health services shall be available to all persons regardless of immigration status, consistent with the Human Dignity Standard.

The system shall have two layers:

Universal Health Insurance, a publicly financed plan that provides comprehensive coverage to every eligible resident.

Supplemental insurance, which individuals may purchase privately for services beyond the standard package, upgraded accommodations, or other added benefits. Supplemental insurance shall add to the public plan and shall not replace it.

Healthcare providers shall remain privately operated and independently managed. The public system shall function primarily as the financing mechanism while preserving provider independence and patient choice.

5.1.1 Covered Services

Coverage shall include all medically necessary:

Primary care

Specialist care

Preventive care

Emergency care

Hospitalization

Surgical care

Mental-health treatment

Substance-use treatment

Prescription drugs

Dental care

Vision care

Hearing care

Home health services

Long-term care

Fertility treatment

Rehabilitation services

Reproductive and maternal health, including contraception, pregnancy and postpartum care, and abortion care (Section 6.1)

Covered services shall carry no copays or deductibles at the point of care. Because removing cost-sharing also removes a common check on how much care is used, spending growth shall be managed through provider-payment design and workforce planning (Sections 5.1.3 and 5.1.5).

The long-term care benefit shall be designed after an independent actuarial study of its sustainability over multiple decades, completed before universal enrollment begins.

5.1.2 Financing

Universal Health Insurance shall be financed through a dedicated Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund, funded by payroll contributions, employer contributions, and income-based taxes (Section 27.3). These contributions are intended to replace the premiums, deductibles, and out-of-pocket costs that households and employers pay today. Savings from consolidated health financing shall lower contribution rates and shall not be counted elsewhere. Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax revenue shall not be used for health financing (Section 27.5). Contribution rates shall be set after independent scoring.

5.1.3 Provider Payments and Rate Recommendations

Provider payments shall follow a national fee schedule set in statute, using Medicare's relative-value (RVU) weighting system as its foundation and adjusted for geographic cost differences.

Medicare-based rates are lower than what private insurers pay hospitals today, so the move toward them shall be gradual and monitored for effects on access, closures, and the workforce.

A health-payment advisory commission in the legislative branch, modeled on the Medicare Payment Advisory Commission (MedPAC), shall recommend annual updates based on medical evidence, operational sustainability, geographic cost differences, and long-term system efficiency. A recommendation shall take effect unless the Secretary of Health and Human Services publishes a written, reasoned decision rejecting it.

5.1.4 Specialty & Geographic Appeals Mechanism

A formal, data-driven appeals process shall allow specialties and regions to challenge reimbursement rates so that rates can be corrected before shortages or closures occur (for example, in oncology or rural family medicine). Appeals shall be decided by administrative law judges.

5.1.5 Workforce Development

Shortages of physicians, nurses, dentists, optometrists, and behavioral-health providers shall be addressed through:

Residency and training-capacity expansion

Rural and underserved-area service incentives

Loan repayment for health professionals with loans taken out before tuition-free public higher education (Section 7.3) takes effect

Workforce development programs

Cross-reference: See Section 3.5 Workforce Mobility & Occupational Licensing Reform and Chapter 18 Science, Research & Space.

5.1.6 Phased Implementation

Implementation shall proceed in phases, with costs evaluated, outcomes measured, and problems corrected at each stage:

Expanded Medicare buy-in options. Because Medicare's Hospital Insurance trust fund is projected to run out of reserves in 2033, this phase shall carry its own financing.

Coverage expansion for children.

Gradual expansion into broader age groups.

Universal enrollment.

Implementing legislation shall coordinate Medicare, Medicaid, veterans' health programs, and employer-sponsored coverage so that no one loses coverage during the transition.

5.1.7 Honest Limit

This framework has not yet been independently scored. Open questions include the exact financing mix and rates, how fast payments should move toward Medicare-based levels, what supplemental coverage may duplicate, how to manage use of care without cost-sharing, the design of a sustainable long-term care benefit, and how quickly the workforce can grow. These are set out for expert review in the white paper.

5.2 Drug Pricing & Dynamic Global Innovation Fund [Statute – High Resistance]

Healthcare affordability should not come at the expense of medical innovation.

5.2.1 National Price Negotiation

The Universal Health Insurance system shall negotiate prescription-drug prices to obtain value for patients and taxpayers while maintaining incentives for research and development. This extends the negotiation Medicare already conducts under current law.

5.2.2 Dynamic Global Innovation Fund

A Dynamic Global Innovation Fund shall support breakthrough therapies and pioneering medical discoveries. Funding shall come from a fixed statutory share of the savings from national drug-price negotiation, subject to an annual cap (Section 27.3). Only the remaining savings shall be counted in health-cost estimates. Awards shall be made through peer review that includes outside scientific reviewers, using criteria set in statute.

5.2.3 Variable Innovation Exclusivity

New therapies receiving approval shall qualify for a period of regulatory market exclusivity ranging from 7 to 15 years, based upon:

Research and development expenditures

Therapeutic benefit

Public-health impact

Scientific advancement

Innovation significance

This exclusivity is a regulatory period layered on top of existing patent rights. It does not shorten patent terms, consistent with U.S. obligations under the WTO TRIPS Agreement.

5.2.4 Public Patent Option and Generic Competition

When the awarded exclusivity period ends, generic competition shall be encouraged and public manufacturing rights shall become available, so that treatment costs decline.

5.2.5 Manufacturing and Strategic Procurement

Pharmaceutical production shall remain primarily within the private sector. The government may contract private manufacturers to produce medicines needed to address shortages or access problems.

5.3 Rural Healthcare Stability Framework [Statute]

Healthcare access shall not depend upon population density. Rural stability programs shall be funded through the Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund (Section 27.4).

5.3.1 Geographic Reimbursement Adjustments

Reimbursement rates shall account for rural operating realities using a Geographic Volatility Index.

5.3.2 Rural Stabilization Grants and Operational Support

Healthcare providers facing patient-volume shortages may receive automatic stabilization payments and targeted grants designed to prevent closure of essential facilities.

Priority shall be given to:

Rural hospitals

Critical access hospitals

Community clinics

Mental-health providers

5.3.3 Minimum Service Guarantees

Basic healthcare services shall remain available regardless of geographic location.

Chapter 6: Reproductive Health Protection

6.1 Reproductive Health Protection [Statute – High Resistance]

Federal law shall protect access to reproductive healthcare, including contraception, abortion care, and pregnancy and postpartum care, nationwide.

Reproductive and maternal health services, including contraception, abortion care, and pregnancy and postpartum care, shall be covered under the public insurance system in Section 5.1.

6.1.1 Abortion Care Is Health Care

Abortion care is women's health care. It shall be legal nationwide so that women can get the medical care they need.

The decision whether to have an abortion belongs to the woman and her doctor. Government shall not substitute its judgment for theirs, and medical decisions shall be guided by clinical standards of care, not by political interference.

6.1.2 Federal Protection of Access

Federal law shall guarantee the legal right to abortion nationwide and shall preempt state laws that ban abortion or impose restrictions that are not medically necessary. Access to medication abortion, including by telehealth, shall be protected from restrictions that are not supported by medical evidence.

6.1.3 Protection for Patients and Providers

Doctors and other clinicians shall be free to provide abortion care according to their medical judgment without threat of criminal or civil penalty. Patients shall not be criminalized for their pregnancy outcomes. Patients, providers, and those who assist them shall be protected from penalties imposed by another state for care that is lawful where it is provided.

6.1.4 Coverage and Access

Abortion care shall be covered under the public insurance system in Section 5.1, and federal policy shall support access in areas with few providers.

6.1.5 Honest Limit

Federal legislation can be repealed by a later Congress, and its constitutional basis will be challenged in court. Because this section leaves individual decisions to patients and their doctors rather than setting legislated limits, expect the sharpest opposition on later-term abortion.

Chapter 7: Education

7.1 Universal Preschool [Statute]

Every four-year-old child shall have access to publicly funded preschool education.

The goals are:

- Early childhood development
- School readiness
- Workforce participation
- Reduced long-term educational inequality

7.2 K-12 Educational Opportunity Framework [Statute]

Every child shall have access to a high-quality public education regardless of zip code, local property values, or family income. Educational opportunity shall be a national commitment rather than a function of local wealth.

7.2.1 Equal Opportunity Funding

Federal and state education funding shall reduce disparities created by local property-tax dependence. Public schools serving low-income communities shall receive sufficient resources to provide educational opportunities substantially equivalent to those available in wealthier districts. Federal funding shall be weighted toward high-poverty districts and tied to state equity-of-funding requirements.

7.2.2 National Education Standards

States shall retain control over curriculum while ensuring students receive adequate instruction in mathematics, science, literacy, civics, history, technology, and critical thinking. Minimum standards in these subjects shall be developed cooperatively with the states and tied to federal funding.

7.3 Tuition-Free Public Higher Education [Statute]

Tuition shall be fully covered at:

- Public universities
- Community colleges
- Trade schools
- Technical institutions

Federal assistance currently tied to tuition costs should instead be redirected toward:

- Housing
- Food
- Books
- Transportation
- Living expenses

for qualifying students.

7.3.1 Existing Student Loan Reform [Statute]

Existing federal student loans shall be refinanced at a near-zero administrative interest rate of 0.01%.

Borrowers making qualifying payments for twenty years (240 monthly payments) shall be eligible for full debt discharge.

Additional penalties, fees, and capitalization of unpaid interest shall be prohibited.

Cost estimates for this provision shall be published under Chapter 27 before implementation.

7.4 STEM Education Pipeline [Statute]

Federal programs shall expand pathways into:

- Science
- Engineering
- Mathematics
- Healthcare
- Technology

Special attention shall be directed toward:

- Rural communities

- Underserved populations
- First-generation students

Chapter 8: Housing & Homelessness

8.1 Affordable Housing Initiative [Statute / Statute – High Resistance]

Housing affordability represents one of the largest economic challenges facing American families.

Federal policy shall focus on increasing housing supply rather than restricting development.

8.1.1 Upzoning Incentives

Federal transportation and housing funding may be conditioned upon local housing production reforms.

8.1.2 Permitting Modernization

Investments shall support:

- Digital permitting systems
- Staffing expansion
- Pre-approved building designs
- Clear, predictable review timelines achieved through staffing and capacity, without weakening environmental or safety standards

These investments apply the national permitting rule in Section 21.9 to housing.

8.1.3 Institutional Ownership Limits

Federal policy shall restrict excessive concentration of single-family housing within large institutional investment portfolios. Limits shall apply to institutional investors whose holdings meet the Dominance Threshold in a local housing market, measured by their share of single-family homes, and shall target purchasing conduct rather than size alone.

8.1.4 Public Housing Developer

A publicly operated housing developer shall construct and maintain mixed-income housing developments in high-demand markets.

8.1.5 Anti-Gouging Rent Caps

Federal incentives shall support state and local caps on annual rent increases tied to inflation, with newly constructed housing exempt for a defined period so that building is not discouraged.

8.1.6 First-Time Homebuyer Assistance

Down payment assistance shall be available expressly to first-time homebuyers. It shall be income-limited and designed (for example, with shared-equity terms) so that it does not simply bid up prices, and it shall be paired with the supply measures above.

8.1.7 Homeowner Protections

Property-tax relief for seniors and low-income homeowners shall ensure that rising land values do not force long-time residents out. Owners shall have a by-right ability to add accessory units or split lots. Housing reforms shall be phased in so that no homeowner's equity is wiped out.

PART III: COMPETITIVE MARKETS

Chapter 9: Competition & Consumer Rights

9.1 Guiding Principle

Markets function best when competition exists.

The objective of antitrust policy is not to punish successful companies.

The objective is to preserve:

- Competition
- Consumer choice
- Market entry
- Entrepreneurship

Economic power should be earned through innovation rather than protected through market dominance.

9.2 Competitive Markets & Anti-Monopoly Act [Statute – High Resistance]

Federal competition policy shall focus on anti-competitive conduct rather than company size alone.

9.2.1 Conduct-Based Principle & Dominance Threshold

Corporate scale alone shall not trigger government intervention.

Government action shall focus on:

- Market abuse
- Exclusionary practices
- Barriers to entry
- Anti-competitive behavior

The additional duties in Sections 9.2.2, 9.2.3, and 9.2.5 shall apply only to firms that meet the Dominance Threshold (see Definitions).

9.2.2 Anti-Self-Preferencing Rule

Digital platforms that meet the Dominance Threshold may not unfairly prioritize their own products or services above competitors utilizing the same platform.

Examples include:

- Search engines
- App stores
- Online marketplaces
- Advertising platforms

9.2.3 Interoperability Requirements

Platforms that meet the Dominance Threshold shall provide reasonable mechanisms allowing consumers to:

- Transfer data
- Switch services
- Communicate across systems

while protecting privacy and security.

9.2.4 Anti-Killer Acquisition Rule

Regulators may block acquisitions primarily intended to eliminate emerging competitors before meaningful competition develops.

9.2.5 Open Standards Requirement

Regulators may require interoperability standards when a firm that meets the Dominance Threshold creates excessive consumer lock-in.

9.2.6 Small Business Competition Office

A dedicated office shall monitor barriers facing:

- Small businesses
- Start-ups
- Independent contractors
- Entrepreneurs

and provide annual recommendations to Congress.

9.3 Rights-Based Data Privacy [Statute]

Individuals shall possess enforceable legal rights over their personal data.

Citizens shall possess the right to:

- View personal data
- Correct personal data
- Delete personal data
- Transfer personal data

without unreasonable barriers.

Corporations may not treat consumer data as a commodity or as permanently owned corporate property.

9.4 Right to Repair [Statute]

Consumers shall have the right to repair products they legally own.

Manufacturers shall provide:

- Replacement parts
- Software tools
- Diagnostic systems
- Repair manuals

on fair and reasonable terms.

Artificial repair barriers designed solely to prevent independent repair shall be prohibited.

Chapter 10: Agriculture & Family Farms

10.1 Agricultural Market Fairness & Family Farm Protection [Statute – High Resistance]

Independent family farms remain essential to:

- Food security
- Rural prosperity
- Property ownership
- Community stability

Federal policy shall promote their long-term viability.

10.1.1 Protecting Family Farms

Priority federal support shall be provided through:

- Succession planning programs

- Beginning farmer programs
- Conservation incentives
- Agricultural lending initiatives

10.1.2 Agricultural Competition Framework

Enhanced antitrust enforcement shall focus on:

- Meat processing
- Seed production
- Fertilizer manufacturing
- Agricultural chemicals
- Grain purchasing networks

10.1.3 Fair Contract Standards

Large agricultural corporations may not engage in:

- Retaliatory contracting
- Coercive exclusivity agreements
- Unjustified discriminatory pricing

against independent producers.

10.1.4 Producer Cooperative Protections

Farmers shall retain the right to organize producer cooperatives and collective bargaining associations.

10.1.5 Agricultural Land Protection

Large acquisitions of agricultural land by:

- Foreign governments
- Foreign state-owned entities
- Institutional investment groups that meet the Dominance Threshold in a regional farmland market

shall receive enhanced federal review.

10.1.6 Working Lands Conservation Partnership [Statute]

Conservation efforts should support working farms rather than displace them.

Programs may include:

- Soil-health incentives
- Watershed protection
- Regenerative agriculture
- Carbon sequestration programs
- Wildlife habitat initiatives

Participation shall remain voluntary.

10.1.7 Nutrition-Oriented Agricultural Support

Federal agricultural subsidies shall prioritize production of foods that contribute to a healthy and affordable national diet. Changes shall be phased in over a multi-year transition so that farmers can adjust crops and contracts.

Priority categories may include:

- Fruits
- Vegetables
- Legumes
- Dairy
- Protein production
- Sustainable soil-health practices

10.1.8 National Farm Risk Protection Program

Family farms shall have access to comprehensive crop and disaster insurance protection. This program shall build on and expand the existing federal crop insurance system.

Coverage shall include:

- Drought
- Flooding
- Severe weather
- Disease outbreaks
- Market-disruption emergencies

Premium assistance shall prioritize family farms and independent producers.

Chapter 11: Trade & Strategic Protection

11.1 Guiding Principle

Trade is a tool for prosperity, not an ideology.

The United States should pursue:

- Free trade where beneficial
- Fair trade where necessary
- Strategic protections where justified

Trade policy should strengthen both economic growth and national resilience.

11.2 Fair Trade & Economic Partnership Act [Statute]

The United States shall pursue mutually beneficial trade relationships with allies and trusted partners.

11.2.1 Allied Trade Framework

Trade agreements should encourage:

- Democratic governance
- Labor standards
- Environmental standards
- Intellectual-property protections
- Fair competition

11.2.2 Strategic Tariff Authority

Targeted tariffs may be imposed against foreign governments engaging in:

- Intellectual property theft
- Currency manipulation
- Forced technology transfer
- State-supported dumping
- Trade discrimination

Tariffs under this section shall be imposed only under authority expressly granted by Congress, subject to congressional review, and shall meet the Strategic Protection Test (see Definitions). The Supreme Court held in *Learning Resources, Inc. v. Trump* (2026) that emergency-powers law does not authorize tariffs; this section makes the authority explicit and accountable.

11.2.3 Supply Chain Protection Standard

Trade restrictions shall be designed to minimize unnecessary disruptions to American businesses dependent upon global supply chains.

Policies must carefully balance:

- National security
- Consumer costs
- Manufacturing competitiveness

11.2.4 Strategic Industry Protection

Special consideration may be given to:

- Semiconductors
- Pharmaceuticals
- Critical minerals
- Energy infrastructure
- Defense technologies

Priority sectors are defined in Section 21.5; this section governs trade treatment only. Any protection shall meet the Strategic Protection Test.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 21 Infrastructure, Industry & Supply Chains.

PART IV: DEMOCRACY, GOVERNANCE & PUBLIC TRUST

Chapter 12: Elections & Democratic Reform

12.1 Democratic Governance Principle

Every eligible citizen should be able to vote.

Every lawful vote should be counted.

Every election result should be transparent, secure, and trusted.

12.2 Automatic Voter Registration [Statute]

Citizens shall be automatically registered upon:

- Reaching voting age
- Obtaining driver's licenses
- Updating government records

while retaining the right to opt out.

12.3 Election Day Accessibility [Statute]

Election Day shall be designated a federal holiday.

Workers shall receive paid time to vote.

12.4 Ranked-Choice Voting & Multi-Member Districts [Statute – High Resistance]

Congressional districts shall be consolidated into regional multi-member districts elected through the Single Transferable Vote (STV) form of ranked-choice voting. This requires repeal of the Uniform Congressional District Act of 1967.

Objectives:

- Reduce gerrymandering
- Expand voter choice
- Improve representation

Multi-member districts substantially reduce, but do not eliminate, the payoff from gerrymandering, because regional boundaries must still be drawn. Final multi-winner results shall be tabulated and audited within a legally defined short window (for example, one week).

12.5 Judicial Term Limits [Statute – High Resistance; Constitutionally Contested]

Federal judges shall serve standardized eighteen-year terms through a staggered implementation process. Sitting judges shall transition to senior status in order of seniority, with the longest-serving judges first, over a phased period. This avoids abruptly stripping any sitting judge's tenure and prevents the timing of enactment from creating partisan windfalls.

Honest limit: many scholars argue that fixed terms for Supreme Court justices require a constitutional amendment under Article III's "good Behaviour" clause. Senior-status rotation is the strongest statutory approach; the age limit in Section 12.6 is the constitutional backstop.

12.6 Age Limit of 68 [Constitutional Amendment]

No person shall run for or hold federal elected office after reaching age 68, and federal judges shall retire at age 68. For judges, service ends at whichever comes first: eighteen years under Section 12.5 or age 68.

The objective is not medical assessment.

The objective is:

- Leadership renewal
- Generational representation
- Long-term institutional vitality

12.7 Campaign Finance Reform [Statute / Constitutional Amendment]

Real-time campaign-finance disclosure shall be required.

A constitutional [Amendment] shall be pursued to overturn Citizens United v. FEC and permit limits on independent political spending by Super PACs, drafted narrowly to protect the press and the associational rights of unions and nonprofit organizations. This is a long-term goal severable from the statutory provisions above.

The congressional stock-trading ban and other ethics protections appear in Chapter 15.

12.8 Election Integrity & Public Trust Act [Statute]

The legitimacy of democratic government depends upon public confidence that elections are secure, accurate, transparent, and fairly administered.

Federal election policy shall strengthen both election security and voter confidence through verifiable voting systems, independent auditing procedures, cybersecurity protections, and safeguards for election officials.

The objective is to ensure that every lawful vote is accurately counted, every election is transparently administered, and every result can be independently verified.

12.8.1 Voter-Verifiable Paper Ballots

All federal elections shall maintain voter-verifiable paper records.

12.8.2 Risk-Limiting Audits

Independent audits shall occur before certification.

12.8.3 Election Cybersecurity

Federal cybersecurity support shall strengthen election infrastructure.

12.8.4 Election Worker Protections

Election officials shall receive protections against intimidation and harassment.

12.8.5 Universal Voter Identification Access

States requiring voter identification must provide:

- Free voter identification
- Convenient access
- Free replacement documents

12.8.6 Anti-Poll Tax Principle

No citizen shall be required to spend personal funds in order to exercise the right to vote.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 15 Ethics & Anti-Corruption.

Chapter 13: Civil Rights & Equal Protection

13.1 Guiding Principle

Every person possesses inherent worth and deserves to be treated with dignity, fairness, and respect. Public institutions should safeguard individual rights, ensure due process, and maintain equal treatment under the law regardless of income, race, religion, sex, disability, age, political affiliation, or citizenship status (Governing Principle 1 and the Human Dignity Standard).

Statutory provisions for this chapter (voting-rights enforcement, anti-discrimination protections, disability rights, and pay transparency) are scheduled for the v1.2 Complete Edition (decision 0003).

Chapter 14: Government Effectiveness

14.1 Guiding Principle

Government should not be judged by its size alone.

Government should be judged by its effectiveness, transparency, accountability, and measurable results.

The purpose of public administration is to deliver services efficiently, responsibly, and in a manner that earns public trust.

Taxpayer resources are valuable and should be managed with the same discipline expected of any successful institution.

14.2 Taxpayer Accountability & Government Performance Act [Statute]

Federal agencies shall be required to regularly demonstrate effectiveness, efficiency, and measurable public benefit.

Programs should be evaluated according to outcomes rather than political ideology.

14.2.1 Ten-Year Performance Reviews

Every major federal program shall be reviewed by the Government Accountability Office, supported by agency Inspectors General, at least once every ten years.

Reviews shall evaluate:

- Program outcomes
- Fiscal sustainability
- Administrative efficiency
- Fraud prevention
- Public utilization
- Cost effectiveness

Findings shall be publicly available.

14.2.2 Public Performance Dashboards

Federal agencies shall maintain public dashboards displaying:

- Program expenditures
- Administrative overhead
- Service delivery times
- Performance indicators
- Outcome measurements

The goal is to make government performance understandable and accessible to citizens.

14.2.3 Automatic Sunset Reviews

New federal programs shall include review dates requiring formal congressional evaluation.

Programs shall not automatically terminate, but Congress must actively assess effectiveness before reauthorization.

14.2.4 Regulatory Simplification Initiative

Federal agencies shall continuously identify:

- Obsolete regulations
- Duplicative rules
- Contradictory requirements
- Excessive paperwork burdens

while preserving:

- Consumer protections
- Public safety
- Labor standards
- Environmental safeguards

14.2.5 One-In-One-Out Administrative Rule

When practical, agencies creating major new reporting requirements should identify existing requirements suitable for elimination or consolidation.

This rule applies only to paperwork and reporting burdens, never to substantive protections for consumers, workers, public health, safety, or the environment. The objective is administrative efficiency rather than deregulation for its own sake.

14.3 Digital Government Modernization [Statute]

Federal services should be accessible through secure and modern digital systems.

Modernization priorities include:

- Secure online filing
- Digital identity verification
- Interagency coordination
- Electronic benefit administration
- Cybersecurity upgrades

Citizens should not be forced to navigate outdated systems to access basic government services.

14.4 Anti-Fraud Enforcement Unit [Statute]

A permanently funded anti-fraud office shall investigate:

- Procurement fraud
- Contractor abuse
- Improper payments
- Grant misuse
- Financial misconduct

Recovered funds shall be returned to taxpayers or the originating program.

14.5 Outcome-Based Pilot Programs [Statute]

Major initiatives may begin as pilot programs before nationwide deployment.

Pilot programs shall be evaluated using measurable outcomes before expansion. Pilots are required only for program designs that have not yet been tested; designs with established evidence may be phased in nationally under Section 27.9.

14.6 Evidence-Based Governance Requirement [Statute]

Federal agencies shall prioritize evidence, data, and measurable outcomes when developing policy.

Whenever feasible, agencies shall utilize:

- Pilot programs
- Independent evaluations
- State-level demonstrations

- Controlled testing
- Long-term outcome assessment

before implementing major nationwide reforms.

Evidence Principle

Good ideas should survive scrutiny.

Bad ideas should be revised regardless of political origin.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 18 Science, Research & Space.

14.7 Government Procurement Reform [Statute]

Federal procurement shall prioritize:

- Competition
- Transparency
- Cost efficiency
- Long-term value

Competitive Bidding Standard

Contracts shall utilize competitive bidding whenever practical.

Contractor Accountability

Contractors repeatedly responsible for:

- Fraud
- Chronic cost overruns
- Performance failures

may be suspended from future contracting.

Cost-Benefit Transparency

Major projects shall publicly disclose:

- Estimated costs
- Actual costs
- Project timelines
- Performance metrics

Chapter 15: Ethics & Anti-Corruption

15.1 Guiding Principle

Public office is a public trust.

Officeholders should serve the public interest rather than private financial interests.

Transparency and accountability are necessary foundations of democratic government.

15.2 Public Integrity & Democratic Accountability Act [Statute]

The federal government shall establish ethics standards designed to prevent corruption, conflicts of interest, and misuse of public office.

15.2.1 Comprehensive Financial Transparency

Federal elected officials and senior executive officers shall publicly disclose:

- Financial assets
- Significant liabilities
- Outside income
- Business interests
- Major gifts above established thresholds

Disclosures shall be searchable and publicly accessible.

15.2.2 Expanded Blind Trust Requirements

Covered officials shall place qualifying investment assets into independently managed blind trusts.

Covered positions include:

- President
- Vice President
- Cabinet officials
- Agency heads
- Members of Congress

15.2.3 Family Anti-Circumvention Rule

Officials may not evade disclosure requirements through transfers to:

- Immediate family members
- Family trusts

- Controlled entities

for the purpose of concealing financial interests.

15.2.4 Stock Trading Ban & Insider Trading Penalties

Members of Congress shall be prohibited from trading individual stocks.

Criminal penalties shall apply to insider trading by government officials.

15.3 Lobbying & Revolving Door Reform [Statute]

Cooling-Off Period

Senior federal officials shall be prohibited from lobbying Congress or federal agencies for a defined post-service period.

Regulatory Capture Prevention

Senior regulators shall be restricted from accepting employment with organizations they directly regulated during their final years of service.

15.4 Federal Contracting Integrity Standards [Statute]

Major federal contractors shall disclose:

- Beneficial ownership
- Major subcontractors
- Significant political contributions
- Prior fraud findings

Repeat offenders may face suspension or debarment.

15.5 Whistleblower Protection Expansion [Statute]

Individuals reporting:

- Waste
- Fraud
- Corruption
- Abuse of authority
- Ethical violations

shall receive strong legal protections.

Independent Reporting Channels

Protected reporting pathways shall exist outside normal chains of command.

15.6 Inspector General Independence [Statute]

Independent Inspectors General shall maintain authority to investigate:

- Political appointees
- Agency leadership
- Procurement misconduct
- Ethics violations

Removal Transparency

Removal of an Inspector General shall require written reasons delivered to Congress at least 30 days in advance. When the office is vacant, the acting Inspector General shall be drawn from its career deputies, and career Inspector General staff shall retain civil-service protections.

15.7 Foreign Influence Safeguards [Statute]

Federal officeholders may not receive:

- Compensation
- Consulting income
- Gifts
- Financial benefits

from foreign governments while serving in office.

15.8 Anti-Nepotism Standards [Statute]

Senior officials shall not appoint immediate family members to positions over which they exercise direct authority.

Hiring shall be based upon merit and qualifications.

15.9 Public Ethics Office & Enforcement [Statute – High Resistance]

A congressional ethics office in the legislative branch shall:

- Conduct ethics investigations involving Members of Congress and congressional staff
- Issue advisory opinions
- Enforce disclosure standards
- Publish annual reports

For the executive branch, the disclosure and conflict-of-interest duties in this chapter shall be enforceable in federal court, audited by Inspectors General, and published through the Citizen Transparency Portal (Section 15.10).

Honest limit: after *Trump v. Slaughter* (2026), the heads of executive agencies can be removed at will, so an independent executive-branch ethics commission would not be durable. The platform relies instead on duties written into statute, enforcement through the courts, and public disclosure.

15.10 Citizen Transparency Portal [Statute]

A public portal shall combine:

- Ethics disclosures
- Campaign finance reports
- Lobbying disclosures
- Procurement information
- Performance dashboards

allowing citizens to monitor government activity through a single platform.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 12 Elections & Democratic Reform and Chapter 14 Government Effectiveness.

15.11 Department of Justice Independence [Statute – High Resistance]

The Department of Justice shall conduct criminal investigations and prosecutorial decisions independently of political direction from the President, Vice President, or political campaign organizations.

Contacts between the White House and the Department regarding specific investigations or prosecutions shall be logged and disclosed to Congress, and career prosecutors shall be protected from retaliation for declining improper direction. Career prosecutors and investigators shall retain civil-service protections as inferior officers and employees.

Honest limit: courts may hold that the Constitution gives the President control over federal prosecutions. If so, the logging, disclosure, and anti-retaliation provisions are the parts most likely to survive.

15.12 Emergency Powers Reform Act [Statute]

National emergencies shall automatically expire after a fixed period unless renewed by joint resolution of Congress.

Congress may also end an emergency early by joint resolution, which is presented to the President in the ordinary way.

Emergency authorities shall be limited to powers directly related to the underlying emergency.

15.13 Presidential Clemency Transparency [Statute]

The President shall retain constitutional pardon authority.

All pardons and commutations shall be accompanied by public disclosure of supporting recommendations and justification.

An independent review board may issue nonbinding public assessments regarding potential conflicts of interest, corruption concerns, or self-dealing.

PART V: JUSTICE, PUBLIC SAFETY & IMMIGRATION

A secure nation requires strong institutions, lawful immigration, effective law enforcement, and respect for constitutional rights.

National security and individual liberty are complementary, not contradictory.

Chapter 16: Criminal Justice & Public Safety

16.1 Guiding Principle

The first responsibility of the criminal justice system is public safety.

The second responsibility is rehabilitation whenever rehabilitation is realistically possible.

Punishment alone is not a public-safety strategy.

Reducing future crime is the ultimate objective.

16.2 Violent Crime Priority Standard [Statute]

Federal law enforcement shall prioritize:

- Violent offenders
- Sexual offenders
- Human traffickers
- Organized criminal enterprises
- Repeat predatory offenders

Resources should focus on individuals who pose the greatest danger to the public.

16.3 Rehabilitation First Framework [Statute]

Whenever public safety allows, non-violent offenders should have access to:

- Education
- Workforce development
- Mental-health treatment
- Substance-abuse treatment
- Reentry support

The purpose of rehabilitation is reducing future victimization.

16.4 Sentencing Review Commission [Statute]

The United States Sentencing Commission, an independent agency in the judicial branch, shall periodically review sentencing policies for:

- Fairness
- Consistency
- Cost effectiveness
- Public-safety outcomes
- Recidivism reduction

Recommendations shall be reported publicly.

16.5 Prison Reentry Initiative [Statute]

Individuals successfully completing sentences shall receive access to:

- Employment assistance
- Housing support
- Credential recognition
- Educational opportunities
- Workforce development

The objective is successful reintegration into society.

16.6 Ban on For-Profit Prisons & Detention [Statute]

The federal government shall terminate contracts with for-profit prison and immigration-detention operators. No federal correctional or immigration-detention facility shall be operated for private profit.

The deprivation of liberty should never become a profit-generating business model, and human incarceration should never create a business incentive to increase imprisonment.

16.7 Public Safety Outcome Standard [Statute]

Justice policies shall be evaluated based upon:

- Crime reduction
- Victim protection
- Public safety
- Reduced recidivism

rather than political ideology.

Cross-reference: See Section 14.6 Evidence-Based Governance Requirement.

16.8 Victim Rights Framework [Statute]

Victims of violent crime shall receive enhanced access to:

- Counseling services
- Legal support
- Restitution assistance
- Victim advocacy services

The justice system must protect both communities and victims while preserving constitutional rights for the accused.

16.9 Ending Qualified Immunity [Statute]

Qualified immunity, a judicially created doctrine, shall be eliminated by statute clarifying 42 U.S.C. Section 1983. A hybrid accountability model shall apply: individual officer civil liability shall be capped (for example, at $25,000), and the employing municipality shall cover remaining damages unless the officer acted in bad faith. This holds departments accountable without exposing officers to personal bankruptcy over split-second judgment calls.

16.10 Firearm Safety [Statute – High Resistance]

Background checks shall be required for all firearm sales and transfers, including private and online sales, with narrow exceptions (such as transfers between close family members).

Extreme risk protection (red flag) orders shall allow a court to temporarily remove firearms from a person who poses a danger to themselves or others. Federal law and federal funding incentives shall support these orders, with due-process protections: notice, a hearing, a clear evidentiary standard, time limits, and a defined path to restore firearm rights.

Honest limit: these measures do not ban any category of firearm. They will face Second Amendment challenges, so due-process protections are essential, and enforcement depends on background-check system funding and compliance.

16.11 Federal Cannabis Legalization [Statute]

Cannabis shall be removed from the federal controlled-substances schedule.

States shall retain authority over regulation within their jurisdictions.

Federal authorities shall expunge qualifying non-violent federal cannabis records.

16.12 Civil Addiction Courts & Public Health Stabilization [Statute]

Low-level possession offenses shall be routed through civil diversion systems rather than traditional criminal incarceration.

Treatment participation must remain voluntary.

Completion of civil diversion shall result in expungement of the related record.

Parity Lock

Diversion systems require adequate treatment capacity before activation.

Proximity Lock

Treatment access must remain geographically accessible to affected populations.

Addiction Hotspots shall receive priority for treatment capacity so that diversion can activate there first.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 5 Universal Health Insurance.

Chapter 17: Immigration & Integration

17.1 Guiding Principle

The United States is both a sovereign nation and a nation of immigrants.

A successful immigration system must balance:

- Border security
- Rule of law
- Economic needs
- Human dignity
- National security
- Individual opportunity

The objective is not merely controlling migration. The objective is creating an immigration system that is secure, orderly, efficient, and humane.

17.2 Immigration Reorganization Framework [Statute]

Federal immigration enforcement shall be reorganized to separate criminal enforcement from civil immigration administration.

The Immigration and Customs Enforcement agency shall be dissolved in its current form, and its functions shall be reassigned as described below.

Criminal Enforcement Division

Specialized units shall focus on:

- Human trafficking
- Cartels
- Organized smuggling

- Transnational criminal activity

Civil Immigration Administration

Administrative functions shall transition to a professional civilian agency emphasizing:

- Efficiency
- Due process
- Customer service
- Legal compliance

The objective is improved effectiveness without weakening enforcement.

17.3 Immigration & National Integration Act [Statute]

Federal immigration policy shall be structured around a simple principle:

Individuals seeking a better life should have a safe, lawful, and achievable path to enter the United States, contribute to society, and pursue opportunity.

17.3.1 Secure, Orderly & Humane Framework

Border security remains a legitimate responsibility of government.

However, enforcement efforts should prioritize:

- Criminal organizations
- Human trafficking networks
- Smuggling enterprises
- National security threats

rather than treating all migrants as criminal actors.

17.3.2 Legal Pathway Modernization

The current immigration system frequently creates unnecessary delays and bureaucratic complexity.

Federal reforms shall:

- Reduce processing delays
- Modernize application systems
- Expand staffing capacity
- Streamline verification procedures
- Improve transparency

The objective is making lawful immigration significantly easier than unlawful immigration.

17.3.3 Workforce & Economic Immigration

Legal immigration pathways shall be expanded in sectors experiencing documented labor shortages.

Priority occupations may include:

- Healthcare
- Engineering
- Scientific research
- Skilled trades
- Advanced manufacturing
- Technology
- Education

Cross-reference: See Section 3.5 Workforce Mobility & Occupational Licensing Reform.

17.3.4 Agricultural & Seasonal Worker Programs

Agricultural production depends heavily on seasonal labor.

The federal government shall maintain accessible guest-worker pathways for:

- Agricultural labor
- Seasonal industries
- Food-production systems

while enforcing:

- Worker protections
- Wage standards
- Safe working conditions

Cross-reference: See Chapter 10 Agriculture & Family Farms.

17.3.5 Dreamers, Long-Term Residents & Citizenship Pathways

Individuals brought to the United States as children should have access to a streamlined pathway to lawful status and eventual citizenship.

Priority shall also be given to long-term residents who:

- Maintain clean records

- Demonstrate economic participation
- Meet legal requirements

Priority shall be given to lawful pathways to status and eventual citizenship for Dreamers, agricultural workers, and long-term productive residents, upon satisfaction of established legal requirements.

17.4 Integration & Civic Participation [Statute]

Immigration success depends upon integration as well as admission.

Federal programs shall support:

- English-language instruction
- Workforce development
- Civic education
- Credential recognition
- Community participation

The goal is helping new Americans become successful contributors to their communities.

17.5 Human Dignity Principle

Every person interacting with America's immigration system shall be treated with:

- Fairness
- Respect
- Due process
- Human dignity

Government should enforce immigration law without abandoning fundamental humanitarian values.

PART VI: SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

Chapter 18: Science, Research & Space

18.1 Guiding Principle

Science is humanity's pursuit of truth.

Scientific discovery is among the most powerful drivers of:

- Economic growth

- Medical advancement
- National security
- Human prosperity
- Technological innovation

Government should support the creation of knowledge while preserving the freedom necessary for scientific inquiry.

18.2 Science, Research & Innovation Leadership Act [Statute]

The United States shall maintain global leadership in scientific research, technological innovation, and advanced development.

18.2.1 National Research Expansion

Federal support shall prioritize:

- Artificial intelligence
- Biotechnology
- Advanced materials
- Quantum systems
- Energy technologies
- Medical research
- Agricultural science

Funding shall be awarded through independent merit-based review.

18.2.2 Basic Research Protection Principle

A dedicated share of federal research expenditures shall support basic research.

Many transformative innovations originate in discoveries that initially lack obvious commercial application.

Government investment exists to preserve the discovery pipeline that private markets alone may underfund.

18.2.3 Scientific Independence Safeguard

Research decisions shall be guided by:

- Scientific merit
- Peer review
- Evidence

rather than political ideology.

The integrity of scientific institutions is essential to public trust.

18.3 Innovation Commercialization Initiative [Statute]

Scientific discoveries should create both knowledge and opportunity.

Programs shall support:

- Technology transfer
- Startup formation
- Research commercialization
- University-industry partnerships
- Applied innovation initiatives

The objective is helping discoveries made in America become businesses built in America.

18.4 National Laboratory Modernization [Statute]

Federal laboratories shall maintain modern facilities capable of supporting world-class research.

Investment priorities include:

- Advanced computing
- Energy systems
- Materials science
- Defense research
- Health research

18.5 Open Science & Public Access [Statute]

Research primarily funded by taxpayers shall eventually become publicly accessible.

Reasonable publication protections may exist.

However, scientific knowledge funded by the public should ultimately benefit the public.

18.6 Strategic Emerging Technologies Program [Statute – High Resistance]

Priority technologies include:

- Artificial intelligence
- Advanced robotics
- Quantum technologies

- Fusion energy
- Advanced nuclear systems
- Semiconductor manufacturing
- Biotechnology

These technologies are expected to shape future economic and geopolitical competitiveness.

Section 21.5 governs domestic production capacity in these fields; this section governs research support.

18.7 Scientific Freedom Principle

Scientific advancement requires:

- Open inquiry
- Academic independence
- Intellectual freedom
- Evidence-based reasoning

Government should support science without attempting to predetermine scientific conclusions.

18.8 Space Guiding Principle

The expansion of human knowledge is a public good.

Space exploration advances:

- Science
- Technology
- Education
- Economic development
- National security

Exploration is both a practical endeavor and a long-term investment in humanity's future.

18.9 Science, Space & Discovery Act [Statute]

The United States shall maintain leadership in:

- Space research
- Space technology
- Planetary science

- Human exploration
- Commercial space development

18.9.1 National Space Leadership

The nation shall continue investing in:

- Deep-space research
- Space science
- Earth observation
- Communications infrastructure
- Exploration technologies

18.9.2 NASA-Space Force Research Partnership

NASA, the United States Space Force, universities, national laboratories, and private industry shall cooperate on research initiatives that expand scientific understanding and technological capability.

NASA shall remain the nation's primary civilian scientific agency.

Space Force participation in these research partnerships shall support infrastructure resilience, navigation, communications security, and space-domain awareness. Space security and resilience programs themselves are governed by Section 24.8.

18.9.3 Public-Private Space Development

Federal policy shall encourage partnerships between:

- NASA
- Universities
- Startups
- Aerospace firms
- Research institutions

to accelerate discovery and innovation.

18.9.4 Long-Term Exploration Goals

National exploration goals may include:

- Lunar research facilities
- Deep-space scientific missions
- Human exploration programs

- Planetary research initiatives

The objective is expanding human knowledge and technological capability.

18.10 Scientific Knowledge Principle

Economic development is important.

Scientific understanding is equally important.

Human civilization benefits when knowledge expands, even when immediate commercial benefit is not obvious.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 18 Science, Research & Space.

Chapter 19: Frontier AI Governance

Aligned with the white paper Frontier AI Governance: A Framework for Innovation, Accountability, and Public Safety *(decisions 0001, 0013).*

19.1 Guiding Principle

Artificial intelligence possesses enormous potential to improve human welfare.

It also introduces novel risks.

Public policy should encourage beneficial innovation while establishing safeguards against catastrophic misuse. Oversight shall rise with the risk a system has been shown to pose: light where risk is low, rigorous where capabilities could cause severe or irreversible harm.

19.2 Frontier AI Safety & Containment Act [Statute – High Resistance]

Frontier AI Systems shall be subject to oversight that scales with demonstrated capability.

19.2.1 Hybrid Trigger: Compute Screens, Capability Decides

A model trained with more than a statutory threshold of training compute shall be evaluated under the Algorithmic Capability Index (Section 19.3). The compute threshold is a screening trigger only. The tier a system reaches on the Index determines the level of review, testing, auditing, and accountability that applies. Capability evaluations may also bring smaller or heavily scaffolded models into scope when they show dangerous capabilities below the compute threshold.

19.2.2 Verified Containment

Potentially dangerous capabilities shall be evaluated only in isolated environments that meet a verified standard:

Network access denied by default, with every exception documented, justified, and monitored

Production systems and credentials kept out of the environment's reach

Real-time monitoring and automated shutdown if the system attempts to breach the environment

Independent testing and certification of the containment environment before each use

19.2.3 Model-Weight Security

Developers of systems at elevated Index tiers shall protect model weights against theft and unauthorized access under auditable cybersecurity standards.

19.2.4 Incident Reporting

Developers shall report significant incidents involving unexpected autonomy, containment failures, security breaches, or other major safety concerns to the oversight agency within 15 days of discovery, or within 24 hours when an incident presents an imminent risk of serious harm. Affected third parties shall be notified promptly. Developers shall maintain continuous monitoring capable of detecting intrusions rapidly.

Timely, good-faith reports shall receive conditional safe-harbor protection from enhanced administrative penalties, modeled on NASA's Aviation Safety Reporting System. The purpose of reporting is systemic learning rather than immediate punishment.

19.2.5 Emergency Suspension

High-capability systems hosted by their developer shall include technical mechanisms capable of suspending operation immediately in an emergency, such as a severe safety failure, security breach, or unexpected autonomous behavior. Both the developer and the oversight agency, by formal administrative order, shall be able to trigger suspension.

Suspension cannot recall open-weight models once their parameters are publicly released. This section therefore governs hosted systems; release rules for open-weight models at higher Index tiers are addressed in Section 19.8.

19.2.6 Whistleblower Protections

Employees and contractors who report safety failures or containment breaches in good faith shall be protected from retaliation, and large developers shall maintain anonymous internal reporting channels.

19.3 Algorithmic Capability Index (ACI) [Statute – High Resistance]

The Index is a tiered rating, not a single aggregate score. Independent evaluators shall assess a system in each category below and assign a tier (for example, Tier 1 through Tier 4). A system's overall rating is the highest tier it reaches in any single category.

Category

Test question

Autonomous Cyber Operations

Can the model independently conduct offensive or defensive cybersecurity tasks?

Self-Replication Attempts

Can the system copy itself, modify its deployment environment, or evade controls?

Financial Autonomy

Can the system independently manage significant financial resources?

Real-World Task Delegation

Can the model coordinate multi-stage objectives involving software, people, or physical infrastructure?

Strategic Planning

Can the system pursue long-term goals across extended time horizons?

Autonomous Tool Use

Can the system independently acquire and use external tools?

Biological and Chemical Uplift

Does the system meaningfully help someone develop biological or chemical weapons?

These categories are illustrative rather than exhaustive. Evaluations shall use standardized protocols with held-out tasks, best-effort elicitation of capability, and checks for systems that change their behavior when they detect testing. Methods shall be published in enough detail to allow replication, while withholding details that would make tests easy to game or disclose hazardous techniques.

19.3.1 Rolling Review Process

The oversight agency shall publish tier definitions and thresholds, and shall review the compute threshold and tier definitions at least annually. A static regulatory framework cannot effectively govern a rapidly evolving field.

19.4 Independent Evaluation & Stochastic Audit Rule [Statute]

Before deployment: systems at elevated Index tiers shall undergo independent third-party review covering security testing, behavioral analysis, capability verification, and systemic risk assessment.

After deployment: regulators may conduct randomized, unannounced audits of deployed systems to detect hidden dangerous behavior, drift from pre-deployment testing, weakened safety controls, and failures to report incidents.

Continuously: independent red-team testing shall catch vulnerabilities introduced through fine-tuning or system updates.

19.5 Developer Accountability for Harm [Statute – High Resistance]

Developers shall bear legal responsibility for measurable harms caused by a system's autonomous operation outside the safety boundaries documented in the developer's published safety framework and reviewed by independent evaluators. Tying responsibility to a published, reviewed framework prevents developers from redefining acceptable risk after an incident.

This is not strict liability for every unforeseen outcome. Liability shall follow a reasonableness standard weighing foreseeability, the safety measures implemented, regulatory compliance, documented safety practices, and the findings of independent evaluators. Compliance with federal safety rules may serve as mitigating evidence but shall not grant blanket immunity. Rules on proximate causation and deliberate misuse by downstream users shall be set in implementing legislation. The law should penalize negligence, not responsible scientific experimentation.

19.6 Oversight Agency, Enforcement & Federal Standards [Statute]

Oversight shall be housed in the Department of Commerce through the National Institute of Standards and Technology. The agency shall have dedicated technical staff, subpoena authority to investigate incidents, secure compute infrastructure to verify held-out evaluations, and civil penalties scaled to developer size, enforceable in federal court. Thresholds, reporting deadlines, and duties shall be fixed in statute, and independent third-party evaluators shall conduct testing, so that oversight does not depend on the discretion of officials who can be removed at will.

Obligations shall scale with Index tier and organizational capacity. Developers below the compute and capability triggers shall face only basic transparency duties and may use federally supported shared evaluation resources. Large frontier developers shall carry the full set of auditing, security, and reporting duties.

Federal law shall set a minimum standard. States may adopt additional safeguards, except that a single national incident-reporting standard shall preempt conflicting state reporting requirements.

19.7 Human Control Principle

Artificial intelligence should augment human decision-making, not replace democratic accountability or human responsibility.

Humans must remain ultimately responsible for consequential decisions affecting:

Rights

Liberty

Safety

Governance

Critical infrastructure operations

19.8 Innovation, International Cooperation & Honest Limit

Federal policy shall sustain public investment in basic AI research, national laboratories, advanced compute infrastructure, STEM education, startups, and commercialization (Chapter 18). The United States shall pursue cooperation with allied nations on technical safety standards, cross-border incident reporting, joint safety research, and standardized evaluation protocols.

Honest limit: the federal role in AI regulation is contested, including through executive action seeking to override state AI laws, and only Congress can clearly preempt state law. The release of open-weight models at higher Index tiers raises unresolved questions: weights cannot be recalled, and rules must protect open academic research and competition. Both are listed as open questions in the white paper.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 18 regarding scientific research and technological development.

PART VII: CLIMATE, INFRASTRUCTURE & RESILIENCE

Chapter 20: Climate & Energy

20.1 Guiding Principle

Environmental stewardship and economic prosperity are not mutually exclusive.

The United States should pursue policies that reduce pollution, strengthen energy security, encourage technological innovation, and preserve environmental resources while protecting workers, consumers, and local communities from unnecessary economic disruption.

The purpose of climate policy is not merely reducing emissions.

It is to build a more resilient, technologically advanced, and economically competitive nation.

20.2 A Price on Pollution [Statute – High Resistance]

The United States shall establish a predictable and gradually increasing fee on carbon dioxide and methane emissions.

The fee shall be collected at the point where fossil fuels enter the economy, including:

- Oil wells
- Natural gas production
- Coal extraction
- Major import terminals

Methane released through leaks, venting, and decomposition rather than combustion cannot be priced at the point of entry. A measured methane fee shall therefore apply to major sources, including oil and gas operations, landfills, and manure lagoons at the largest confined animal feeding operations, under federal measurement and reporting standards. Methane from livestock digestion and from family farms shall be reduced through paid, voluntary incentives under Section 10.1.6, not through the fee.

Fee revenue shall be divided by statute, with each share used only as stated: 80 percent to the household dividend (Section 20.2.1), 10 percent to the Transition Fund (Section 20.2.2), and 10 percent to the General Fund for one-time or time-limited costs only (Section 27.3).

The objective is to incorporate environmental costs into market decisions while allowing businesses and consumers flexibility in how they respond.

20.2.1 Household Dividend

Eighty percent of carbon- and methane-fee revenue, together with all Carbon Border Protection Tariff receipts, shall be returned directly to citizens through equal per-person dividend payments.

The dividend system shall:

- Protect consumer purchasing power
- Offset higher energy costs
- Ensure lower-income households are not disproportionately affected

Climate policy should not place excessive burdens on working families.

20.2.2 Expanded Transition Fund

Ten percent of carbon- and methane-fee revenue shall support communities affected by energy-sector transitions. The Transition Fund shall end on a date fixed in statute.

Eligible investments include:

- Workforce retraining
- Infrastructure modernization
- Business development
- Community revitalization
- Economic diversification
- Educational programs

Transition Community Principle

Workers and communities that helped power the nation's prosperity should not be abandoned during periods of economic transformation.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 21 Infrastructure, Industry & Supply Chains.

20.3 Carbon Border Protection Tariff [Statute – High Resistance]

To prevent carbon leakage and unfair competition, imported goods produced under weaker environmental standards may be subject to border adjustments.

The tariff shall apply only to the following industries, and may be extended to others only by statute:

- Steel
- Aluminum
- Cement

Tariff receipts shall be paid out through the household dividend (Section 20.2.1), not to the domestic industries the tariff protects.

The objective is preserving domestic competitiveness while encouraging cleaner production globally.

20.4 Energy System Modernization [Statute]

The United States shall maintain a reliable, affordable, and resilient energy system.

Federal support shall include public investment in research, manufacturing, and deployment of:

- Grid modernization
- Energy storage

- Advanced nuclear power
- Wind, solar, and hydroelectric generation
- Transmission expansion
- Research and development

The purpose is energy abundance, reliability, and long-term stability.

Because the best mix of wind, solar, hydroelectric, and nuclear power differs by region, federal planning shall support regionally tailored generation mixes connected by interregional transmission. Public investment shall aim to lower the cost and increase the supply of clean energy.

20.5 Advanced Nuclear Deployment [Statute – High Resistance]

Advanced nuclear technologies may play a critical role in achieving:

- Long-term energy security
- Grid reliability
- Low-emission electricity generation

Federal policy shall support:

- Research
- Demonstration projects
- Licensing modernization
- Workforce development

while maintaining strong safety standards.

20.6 Critical Clean Energy Infrastructure [Statute – High Resistance]

Nationally significant energy infrastructure shall be eligible for the coordinated review in Section 21.9, which reduces duplication and delay without weakening environmental or safety review. Eligible projects may include:

- Interstate transmission systems
- Advanced nuclear facilities
- Strategic energy infrastructure

20.7 Conservation & Environmental Stewardship [Statute]

Federal conservation policy shall emphasize:

- Clean water

- Healthy soil
- Wildlife habitat
- Forest health
- Watershed protection

Whenever possible, federal programs should promote voluntary participation and partnership rather than command-and-control regulation.

Chapter 21: Infrastructure, Industry & Supply Chains

21.1 Guiding Principle

Infrastructure and productive capacity are the foundations of national prosperity.

Markets create growth, but growth depends upon reliable transportation networks, energy systems, communications infrastructure, supply chains, and productive industrial capacity.

A modern economy requires both.

21.2 National Infrastructure & Strategic Capacity Act [Statute]

Federal policy shall support long-term investment in infrastructure and productive capacity necessary for future economic growth.

21.2.1 National Infrastructure Renewal Program

Investment priorities include:

- Roads
- Bridges
- Ports
- Airports
- Freight rail
- Inland waterways
- Public transit
- Water systems
- Wastewater infrastructure

Infrastructure spending should emphasize long-term maintenance and modernization.

21.2.2 State Partnership Framework

Federal programs should operate through cooperative state and local partnerships whenever practical.

Funding decisions shall be guided by:

- Need
- Economic impact
- Safety
- Resilience

rather than political considerations.

21.3 Grid Modernization & Energy Reliability [Statute]

The electrical grid shall be modernized to improve:

- Reliability
- Capacity
- Cybersecurity
- Interregional connectivity
- Disaster resilience

Priority shall be given to projects improving national energy stability.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 20 Climate & Energy.

21.4 Public Community Internet [Statute – High Resistance]

States may not prohibit municipalities from constructing or operating public broadband infrastructure.

Communities shall retain the right to establish publicly owned broadband services whenever local residents determine such systems are necessary.

Broadband access shall be treated as essential economic infrastructure.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 21 Infrastructure, Industry & Supply Chains.

21.5 Strategic Industrial Capacity Initiative [Statute – High Resistance]

The United States shall maintain domestic capabilities in strategically important industries.

Priority sectors include:

- Semiconductors
- Biotechnology
- Pharmaceuticals
- Aerospace

- Robotics
- Advanced manufacturing
- Nuclear technologies

The objective is resilience rather than economic isolation.

21.5.1 Competitive Neutrality Principle

Government support shall remain open to firms of varying size whenever possible.

Industrial policy should strengthen competition rather than entrench existing monopolies.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 9 Competition & Consumer Rights.

21.6 Supply Chain Resilience Program [Statute]

Federal agencies shall identify vulnerabilities within supply chains affecting:

- National security
- Public health
- Food security
- Energy reliability
- Manufacturing

The government may support:

- Strategic reserves
- Diversified sourcing
- Domestic production capacity

when excessive dependence creates national risk.

This section is the central supply-chain program. Sections 21.6.1, 11.2.4, and 22.6 apply it to domestic sourcing, trade treatment, and emergency reserves.

21.6.1 Strategic Domestic Production [Statute]

Critical emergency supplies shall maintain domestic production capacity. The list of critical supplies shall be narrow and statutorily defined, recommended by a technical office at the national laboratories using a published method rather than by industry petition, issued by rule subject to congressional review, required to meet the Strategic Protection Test, and aligned with the vulnerability reviews in Section 21.6 and the reserves in Section 22.6.

21.7 Workforce Development Partnership [Statute]

Infrastructure and industrial investment shall be coordinated with workforce development.

Programs may include:

- Apprenticeships
- Community-college partnerships
- Trade certification programs
- Employer-sponsored training

Cross-reference: See Chapter 3 Work, Wages & Family.

21.8 Domestic Production Preference [Statute]

Federal projects receiving major public support should prioritize domestic production whenever:

- Quality remains competitive
- Price differences remain reasonable
- Supply needs can be met

The goal is strengthening domestic productive capacity while maintaining competition. Preferences under this section shall meet the Strategic Protection Test.

Cross-reference: Section 21.6 is the central supply-chain program.

21.9 National Permitting Reform [Statute – High Resistance]

Major infrastructure projects shall receive coordinated review procedures supported by funded permitting staff. This section is the platform's single permitting rule; Sections 8.1.2 and 20.6 apply it to housing and to energy infrastructure.

One Project, One Review

Federal agencies shall coordinate reviews to reduce duplication while preserving:

- Environmental protections
- Public safety standards
- Property-right protections

Environmental and safety reviews shall not be weakened, and public participation shall be preserved. Delays shall be reduced through funded permitting staff, coordinated agency review, and clear timelines, not by narrowing the scope of review.

Efficient permitting is not the same as weaker standards.

Chapter 22: Disaster Resilience & Emergency Preparedness

22.1 Guiding Principle

The most effective disaster response begins before disaster strikes.

Preparedness, resilience, and mitigation save lives, reduce economic damage, and improve recovery outcomes.

Federal disaster policy should focus on both response and prevention.

22.2 National Resilience & Emergency Preparedness Act [Statute]

The United States shall maintain the capacity to prepare for, respond to, and recover from major emergencies.

Covered events include:

- Natural disasters
- Pandemics
- Cyberattacks
- Infrastructure failures
- Supply-chain disruptions
- National emergencies

22.3 National Risk Assessment Program [Statute]

Federal agencies shall maintain continuous assessments of major national risks.

Assessments shall guide:

- Resource allocation
- Preparedness planning
- Infrastructure investment
- Interagency coordination

22.4 Critical Infrastructure Resilience Initiative [Statute]

Priority sectors include:

- Energy
- Water
- Transportation
- Communications

- Healthcare
- Data systems

Infrastructure planning shall emphasize redundancy and continuity.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 21 Infrastructure, Industry & Supply Chains.

22.5 Disaster Mitigation First Policy [Statute]

Federal programs should prioritize projects that reduce future disaster costs.

Eligible activities include:

- Flood protection
- Wildfire mitigation
- Storm hardening
- Earthquake retrofits
- Coastal resilience

Prevention Investment Standard

Mitigation investments should be favored when evidence demonstrates long-term cost savings relative to repeated recovery expenditures.

22.6 Emergency Supply Reserve System [Statute]

The federal government shall maintain strategic reserves of critical emergency supplies.

Priority categories include:

- Medical equipment
- Essential medications
- Fuel reserves
- Communications equipment
- Water-treatment supplies

Regular inventory rotation shall ensure readiness.

Reserve categories shall align with the critical-supplies list in Section 21.6.1 and the vulnerability findings under Section 21.6.

22.7 Public Health Emergency Preparedness [Statute]

Permanent preparedness capabilities shall include:

- Medical surge capacity

- Laboratory readiness
- Vaccine infrastructure
- Emergency logistics systems
- Public-health workforce development

Cross-reference: See Chapter 5 Universal Health Insurance.

22.8 Rapid Disaster Response Framework [Statute]

Certain emergency declarations may trigger automatic deployment of:

- Search-and-rescue assets
- Emergency logistics
- Temporary housing support
- Medical assistance
- Infrastructure-repair funding

The objective is reducing bureaucratic delays during crises.

22.9 Community Resilience Partnerships [Statute]

Federal grants shall support local preparedness efforts.

Eligible projects include:

- Emergency planning
- Evacuation systems
- Shelter facilities
- Backup power systems
- Communications modernization

Local communities often possess the strongest understanding of regional risks.

22.10 Build Back Stronger Standard [Statute]

Federal reconstruction programs shall incorporate resilience improvements whenever practical.

The objective is reducing repeated losses rather than repeatedly rebuilding vulnerable infrastructure in the same manner.

22.11 Continuity of Government Standards [Statute]

Federal agencies shall maintain plans ensuring continuation of critical functions during emergencies.

Priority functions include:

- Public safety
- Benefit administration
- Health coordination
- Financial-system stability
- National security operations

PART VIII: SECURITY & GLOBAL LEADERSHIP

Chapter 23: Foreign Policy & Diplomacy

23.1 Guiding Principle

Lasting security is built not only through military strength, but through diplomacy, partnership, economic cooperation, and mutual trust.

The United States should seek a world in which more nations view America as a trusted partner than as an adversary.

Military power remains an essential instrument of national defense, but diplomacy should remain the first instrument of foreign policy whenever practical.

23.2 Defensive Foreign Policy [Statute / Executive]

The United States shall maintain military capabilities sufficient to:

- Defend the nation
- Protect allies
- Secure global trade
- Deter aggression

The nation shall end foreign regime-change operations and shall reduce reliance on:

- Long-term occupations
- Open-ended military engagements

whenever practical.

Forward Presence & Burden-Sharing

No new permanent overseas military base shall be established without congressional authorization. Allies shall share defense burdens through periodic burden-sharing reviews, and the Department of Defense shall report to Congress at regular intervals on global force posture,

including where maritime and over-the-horizon capabilities can substitute for forward presence. Ending regime-change operations is a core commitment that does not depend on force-posture decisions.

Peace Through Strength

Military strength exists primarily to prevent war, not seek it.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 24 Defense.

23.3 Diplomacy First Framework [Statute]

The United States shall prioritize:

- Diplomacy
- Conflict prevention
- Alliance management
- Economic cooperation
- Peaceful dispute resolution

before the use of military force.

Diplomacy First Principle

Military action should remain available when necessary, but policymakers should exhaust reasonable diplomatic alternatives before resorting to armed conflict.

23.4 Alliance & Strategic Partnership Initiative [Statute]

The United States shall maintain and strengthen alliances with democratic partners around the world.

Priority objectives include:

- Defense cooperation
- Economic cooperation
- Scientific collaboration
- Intelligence sharing
- Joint security planning

Strong alliances reduce the likelihood of conflict and multiply collective security.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 24 Defense.

23.5 Strategic Foreign Assistance Program [Statute]

Foreign assistance should advance both humanitarian values and long-term stability.

Federal foreign-aid programs shall support three primary objectives:

23.5.1 Humanitarian Stability

Programs may support:

- Disaster relief
- Food security
- Refugee assistance
- Clean water access
- Public health initiatives

The objective is reducing human suffering and preventing instability before it becomes crisis.

23.5.2 Economic Development

Programs may support:

- Education
- Workforce development
- Agricultural modernization
- Infrastructure investment
- Disease prevention

Economic development reduces long-term instability and creates future trading partners.

23.5.3 Democratic Resilience

The United States may support initiatives that encourage:

- Transparent governance
- Anti-corruption reforms
- Civil society development
- Independent institutions
- Rule of law

The objective is supporting stable societies rather than imposing political outcomes.

23.6 Accountability Standards for Foreign Assistance [Statute]

All major aid programs shall include:

- Performance metrics

- Independent audits
- Transparency reporting
- Outcome evaluations

Foreign assistance should be held to the same accountability standards expected of domestic programs.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 14 Government Effectiveness.

23.7 Friendship Through Partnership Principle

People who experience American assistance, cooperation, and goodwill are more likely to become future partners than future adversaries.

Economic cooperation, educational exchanges, scientific partnerships, and humanitarian assistance can strengthen international relationships while advancing American interests.

23.8 International Scientific & Educational Cooperation [Statute]

The United States shall encourage peaceful international collaboration involving:

- Scientific research
- Medical innovation
- Educational exchanges
- Space exploration
- Technology development

Such cooperation promotes both security and prosperity.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 18.

Chapter 24: Defense

24.1 Guiding Principle

The United States shall maintain the world's most capable defensive military while ensuring responsible stewardship of public resources.

Military strength is essential to:

- Deterring aggression
- Protecting allies
- Preserving freedom of navigation
- Defending national sovereignty

Defense spending should prioritize capability and readiness rather than political favoritism.

24.2 Military Readiness, Modernization & Strategic Procurement Act [Statute – High Resistance]

Defense procurement shall emphasize:

- Military effectiveness
- Technological superiority
- Operational readiness
- Cost accountability

24.2.1 Military Capability First Doctrine

Procurement decisions should prioritize measurable capability and mission effectiveness.

Weapons systems should be evaluated according to performance rather than political considerations.

24.2.2 Competitive Defense Acquisition Reform

The Department of Defense shall maximize competition whenever practical.

Competitive Procurement Standard

Major acquisition programs should utilize competitive bidding processes.

Sole-Source Transparency

Contracts awarded without competition shall require public justification whenever national security permits.

24.2.3 Defense Cost Overrun Accountability

Programs experiencing significant:

- Cost overruns
- Performance failures
- Schedule delays

shall automatically undergo independent review.

Potential remedies include:

- Restructuring
- Re-competition
- Program cancellation

24.3 Defense Industrial Base Resilience [Statute]

The United States shall maintain domestic production capacity for strategically important defense industries.

Priority sectors include:

- Shipbuilding
- Aerospace
- Electronics
- Semiconductors
- Munitions
- Critical minerals

These defense sectors are covered by the national supply-chain program (Section 21.6) and the strategic industrial capacity initiative (Section 21.5); this section sets defense-specific priorities only. Sourcing requirements under this section shall meet the Strategic Protection Test.

24.4 Rapid Technology Adoption Program [Statute]

The Department of Defense shall accelerate adoption of technologies including:

- Artificial intelligence
- Robotics
- Advanced manufacturing
- Cybersecurity
- Space systems
- Quantum technologies

Innovation should not become trapped in bureaucratic acquisition processes.

24.5 Startup & Small Contractor Competition Initiative [Statute]

Federal procurement shall create pathways allowing innovative small businesses to compete for defense contracts.

Programs may include:

- Prototype projects
- Demonstration programs
- Innovation grants
- Accelerated procurement channels

The objective is increasing innovation and competition.

24.6 Military Logistics & Readiness Modernization [Statute]

Readiness planning shall emphasize:

- Supply-chain resilience
- Fuel security
- Transportation capacity
- Maintenance readiness
- Cyber resilience

A modern military depends upon logistics as much as weapon systems.

24.7 Cyber Defense & Digital Security Program [Statute – High Resistance]

The federal government shall continuously strengthen military cyber capabilities.

Priority areas include:

- Network defense
- Supply-chain security
- Communications protection
- Infrastructure coordination

Cybersecurity is now a core national-defense requirement.

24.8 Space Security & Resilience Initiative [Statute – High Resistance]

Space-based systems support:

- Navigation
- Communications
- Weather forecasting
- Missile warning
- Intelligence systems

Federal policy shall ensure their resilience and continuity.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 18 Science, Research & Space.

24.9 Service Member Quality of Life Standard [Statute]

Military readiness depends upon talented personnel.

Federal policy shall prioritize:

- Housing quality
- Healthcare access
- Family support services
- Education opportunities
- Transition assistance

for service members and military families.

24.10 Veterans Skills Transition Program [Statute]

Military training and certifications shall receive recognition within civilian workforce systems whenever practical.

Cross-reference: See Section 3.5 Workforce Mobility & Occupational Licensing Reform.

24.11 Strategic Deterrence Principle

The purpose of military strength is preserving peace through deterrence.

Military power should defend national interests and allies while avoiding unnecessary intervention and open-ended nation-building commitments.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 23 Foreign Policy & Diplomacy.

24.12 Defense Budget Level [Statute]

Defense spending shall be held roughly constant in real, inflation-adjusted terms. Savings from procurement reform under Section 24.2 shall be reinvested in readiness and service-member quality of life, and shall not be counted as financing for other programs in this platform (Chapter 27).

Chapter 25: National Service

25.1 Guiding Principle

Strong nations are built by engaged citizens.

Government can provide opportunity.

Markets can create prosperity.

But communities thrive only when citizens actively contribute to the common good.

National service should strengthen civic trust, build skills, and foster shared responsibility.

Participation shall remain entirely voluntary.

25.2 National Service & Civic Engagement Act [Statute]

The federal government shall support voluntary service opportunities designed to strengthen communities while expanding educational and career opportunities.

The purpose of service is not compulsory labor.

The purpose is creating opportunities for citizens to contribute while developing skills and experience.

25.3 American Service Corps [Statute]

A voluntary national-service framework shall provide opportunities in:

- Disaster response
- Environmental conservation
- Infrastructure projects
- Education support
- Public-health outreach
- Elder care
- Community development
- Veterans assistance

Programs may operate through partnerships with:

- Nonprofits
- State governments
- Local governments
- Tribal governments
- Educational institutions

25.4 Service Scholarship Benefit [Statute]

Individuals successfully completing approved service terms shall receive flexible education and career benefits. Because tuition at public colleges, universities, and trade schools is covered under Section 7.3, benefits may be used for:

- Living costs while enrolled, such as housing, food, books, and transportation
- Apprenticeships and professional certifications
- Graduate or professional study
- Repayment of existing student loans

Educational Opportunity Principle

National service should expand opportunity rather than replace traditional educational pathways.

Cross-reference: See Chapter 7 Education.

25.5 Living Allowance Framework [Statute]

Full-time service participants shall receive:

- Living stipends
- Healthcare coverage through Universal Health Insurance (Chapter 5)
- Transportation support when necessary
- Housing assistance where appropriate

Compensation should support participation without transforming service into a conventional employment program.

25.6 Disaster Response Reserve Corps [Statute]

A specialized service track shall support Chapter 22 Disaster Resilience objectives.

Participants may receive training in:

- Emergency communications
- Shelter management
- Logistics support
- Disaster recovery
- Community resilience planning

Cross-reference: See Chapter 22 Disaster Resilience & Emergency Preparedness.

25.7 Conservation & Public Lands Corps [Statute]

Participants may contribute to projects involving:

- Reforestation
- Trail maintenance
- Habitat restoration
- Watershed improvement
- Wildfire mitigation
- Public-land stewardship

The program strengthens both environmental conservation and local economic development.

25.8 Community Health & Care Corps [Statute]

Participants may assist organizations involved in:

- Elder care
- Disability services
- Public-health outreach
- Community health initiatives
- Mental-health support programs

Service members shall supplement, not replace, trained professionals.

25.9 Infrastructure & Skilled Trades Track [Statute]

Service opportunities may include:

- Broadband deployment
- Housing rehabilitation
- Infrastructure maintenance
- Energy-efficiency projects
- Water-system upgrades

Participation may count toward apprenticeship requirements where appropriate.

Cross-reference: See Chapters 3 and 21.

25.10 Civic Leadership Fellowship Program [Statute]

Outstanding participants may compete for fellowships supporting careers in:

- Public administration
- Education
- Scientific research
- Emergency management
- Community development

The objective is cultivating future civic leaders.

25.11 National Unity Principle

National service should bring Americans together across:

- Geographic differences

- Economic backgrounds
- Cultural communities
- Political affiliations

The purpose is strengthening civic bonds and reinforcing the idea that citizenship carries both rights and responsibilities.

PART IX: LONG-TERM SUSTAINABILITY

Chapter 26: Social Security & Retirement Security

Aligned with the white paper Social Security Solvency: A Proposal for Long-Term Retirement Security *(decisions 0001, 0009, 0010).*

26.1 Guiding Principle

Social Security is one of the most successful anti-poverty programs in American history.

Its long-term solvency should be secured without:

- Raising the retirement age
- Reducing earned benefits
- Shifting excessive costs onto future generations

Retirement security is a foundational component of economic stability. Social Security's purpose is to keep retired Americans out of poverty, not to replace very high earnings.

26.2 Social Security Solvency Overhaul [Statute]

The federal government shall strengthen Social Security through revenue reforms rather than benefit reductions.

The purpose is ensuring sustainable benefits for future retirees while preserving commitments made to current beneficiaries.

26.2.1 Elimination of the Payroll Tax Cap

The Social Security payroll tax cap shall be eliminated, so that all covered earnings are subject to contributions rather than only earnings up to the taxable maximum. Medicare's Hospital Insurance payroll tax already applies to all earnings, providing a precedent. Treatment of the employer's share shall be specified in implementing legislation.

26.2.2 No Additional Benefits Above the Taxable Maximum

Earnings above the taxable maximum shall not increase Social Security benefits. Benefits shall continue to be calculated only on earnings up to the taxable maximum, which shall continue to rise each year with average wage growth as under current law.

This is a deliberate financing choice: contributions above the maximum support a program whose purpose is preventing poverty in old age, without adding future benefit obligations. Economists and policymakers may reasonably disagree about whether those contributions are best described as social-insurance financing, progressive taxation, or both.

26.2.3 Protected Middle-Income Structure

No payroll-tax rate increase shall apply to earnings at or below the taxable maximum. Additional financing shall come from earnings above it, protecting:

- Middle-income workers
- Small-business employees
- Working families

26.3 Pass-Through & Business Income Reform [Statute]

High-income individuals should not be able to avoid Social Security contributions through accounting structures.

Pass-Through Net

Business income from:

- Partnerships
- S-Corporations
- Sole Proprietorships

shall be subject to contributions on the same basis as wages, regardless of legal structure.

Anti-Sheltering Rule

Structures designed primarily to avoid Social Security contributions shall face corrective taxation.

26.4 Social Security Endowment [Statute]

A supplemental Social Security Endowment shall be funded only from revenue raised by the reforms in Sections 26.2 and 26.3 that exceeds what is needed to pay scheduled benefits and maintain required trust-fund reserves. If no such excess exists, the Endowment shall not be funded. Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax revenue shall not be used for the Endowment (Section 27.3).

The Endowment shall supplement, not replace, payroll financing, and shall operate under strict rules:

Independent management: investment decisions insulated from routine political pressure through a passive mandate fixed in statute.

Broad index investing: assets held in diversified market index funds rather than politically directed investments.

Non-voting ownership: the government shall not acquire control of private companies through Endowment holdings.

Transparency: annual reports, performance and cost disclosures, and independent audits.

Because the trust funds now hold only special Treasury securities, investing Endowment assets in market index funds requires authorizing legislation.

Long-Term Compound Growth Principle

The purpose of investment is to increase long-term trust-fund resilience while avoiding government control over private companies.

26.5 Retirement Age and Means Testing [Statute]

The full retirement age shall remain at its current level of 67, with no further increase. Gains in life expectancy have not been shared equally, and workers in physically demanding occupations often cannot extend their careers.

No new means test shall reduce benefits based on income or wealth. Social Security already replaces a larger share of earnings for lower earners, and higher-income retirees pay income tax on up to 85 percent of their benefits. Every covered worker shall continue to contribute and to receive a benefit.

26.6 Honest Limit

These reforms have not yet been scored by Social Security's Office of the Chief Actuary. Past scoring suggests that eliminating the cap without crediting the added earnings toward benefits would close roughly half of the current 75-year deficit of 4.42 percent of taxable payroll. This platform therefore does not claim full solvency until the reforms are scored. How to close any remaining gap without benefit cuts or a higher retirement age is presented as an open question for economists and actuaries in the white paper.

26.7 Retirement Security Principle

Economic dignity should not end when work ends.

Citizens who contribute throughout their lives should have confidence that Social Security will remain stable, reliable, and available for future generations.

Chapter 27: Master Financing Framework

This chapter is the single authority for every revenue and spending rule in the platform. Decision records: 0004–0008.

27.1 Guiding Principle

A platform is only as credible as its funding. Every major commitment in this document shall have an identified source of revenue, an independent cost estimate, and a realistic implementation sequence.

Two rules follow. Each source of revenue shall be assigned to exactly one use, so that no dollar is promised twice. Recurring obligations shall be paid only from stable revenue; revenue that

swings with markets or shrinks over time shall pay only for reserves, one-time investments, or time-limited programs.

27.2 Funding Source Requirement [Statute]

Before any major new program in this platform takes effect, an independent cost estimate and its assigned revenue stream under Section 27.3 shall be published. Programs shall be sequenced so that new obligations do not outpace identified revenue.

27.3 Revenue Assignment Rule [Statute]

Each revenue stream shall be dedicated to the single use listed below. No revenue stream shall be counted toward more than one use, and no program shall claim a stream assigned elsewhere.

Revenue stream

Behavior

Single use

Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax (Section 2.1), including shares paid in kind under Section 2.2

Swings with markets

Sovereign Wealth Reserve, under Section 27.5

Federal tax fairness measures: capital gains taxed as ordinary income above a high-income threshold, restored top income-tax brackets, a strengthened corporate minimum tax, and estate-tax reform (rates set after independent scoring)

Stable

General Fund, for the recurring programs listed in Section 27.4

Universal Health Insurance contributions: payroll, employer, and income-based (Section 5.1)

Stable

Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund

Savings from consolidated health financing

Stable once realized

Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund, by lowering contribution rates

A fixed statutory share of savings from national drug-price negotiation

Stable

Dynamic Global Innovation Fund (Section 5.2); only the remaining savings are counted in health-cost estimates

Social Security payroll reforms (Sections 26.2 and 26.3)

Stable

Social Security trust funds; any revenue beyond scheduled benefits and required reserves goes to the Social Security Endowment (Section 26.4)

Social Security Endowment investment returns

Swings with markets

Social Security trust funds

Carbon and methane fees, 80 percent

Shrinks over time

Equal per-person household dividend (Section 20.2.1)

Carbon and methane fees, 10 percent

Shrinks over time

Transition Fund, which shall end on a date fixed in statute (Section 20.2.2)

Carbon and methane fees, 10 percent

Shrinks over time

General Fund, for one-time or time-limited costs only

Carbon Border Protection Tariff receipts (Section 20.3)

Shrinks over time

Equal per-person household dividend

Strategic tariffs (Section 11.2.2)

Unpredictable

General Fund; never counted as platform financing

Recovered fraud and improper payments (Section 14.4)

Unpredictable

Returned to the program they came from; not counted as platform revenue

Borrowing

—

Long-lived productive assets only, under Section 27.7

27.4 Program Funding Map [Statute]

Each major program shall draw only on the stream listed here. Independent cost estimates shall be published under Section 27.10 before each program takes effect.

Program

Recurring or one-time

Funded by

Universal Health Insurance, including rural stabilization

Recurring

Universal Health Insurance Trust Fund

Dynamic Global Innovation Fund

Recurring, capped

Share of drug-negotiation savings

Paid leave, childcare and eldercare cost caps

Recurring

General Fund (tax fairness measures)

Universal preschool, K-12 equity funding, tuition-free public higher education

Recurring

General Fund (tax fairness measures)

Existing student-loan reform

One-time, phased

General Fund (tax fairness measures)

Public housing developer and housing programs

Recurring

General Fund (tax fairness measures)

Research expansion and national service

Recurring

General Fund (tax fairness measures)

National Farm Risk Protection Program

Recurring

General Fund (tax fairness measures)

Infrastructure, grid, and public broadband

One-time

Productive borrowing and the 10 percent carbon General Fund share

Transition Fund

Time-limited

10 percent carbon Transition share

Household dividend

Ongoing while fees are collected

80 percent carbon share and border tariff receipts

27.5 Sovereign Wealth Reserve [Statute]

The Sovereign Wealth Reserve (Section 1.3) shall exist only to stabilize the economy in recessions.

Funding: all Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax revenue shall be deposited in the Reserve until its stabilization balance reaches a target fixed in statute as a share of GDP.

Above the target: further deposits shall go to a Capital Investment Account, which may fund one-time capital projects only and never recurring programs.

Investment: assets shall be held in broad, passive index funds managed by private managers selected through competitive bidding, with no voting rights in any company.

Drawing: the stabilization balance may be drawn only when the recession trigger in Section 1.2 is met.

Refilling: once recovery is confirmed under Section 1.2, deposits shall restore the balance to its target before anything goes to the Capital Investment Account.

No other claims: no program, fund, or endowment may draw on the Reserve.

27.6 Funded Spending Cap [Statute]

The baseline spending cap in Section 1.2 may rise only by the independently scored revenue that a newly enacted program brings with it under Section 27.3.

27.7 Borrowing Rule [Statute]

Borrowing may finance long-lived productive assets, such as infrastructure, grid and transmission, and research facilities. Borrowing shall not finance recurring obligations.

27.8 No Double Counting [Statute]

Each dollar of revenue or savings shall be counted once. Cost estimates shall show net figures. For example, Universal Health Insurance estimates shall count only the drug-negotiation savings that remain after the Innovation Fund's share.

27.9 Phased Implementation [Statute]

Programs shall be phased in by feasibility: first low-cost statutory reforms (such as voter registration, cannabis legalization, and anti-corruption measures), then revenue measures, and finally the largest new programs (health insurance, childcare, tuition-free higher education, K-12 equity funding, student loan reform, and expanded farm risk protection). No program in the final group shall take effect until the revenue assigned to it has been enacted and independently scored.

27.10 Independent Costing [Statute]

The Congressional Budget Office and the Joint Committee on Taxation shall estimate the cost of each major program and the yield of each revenue measure, and the estimates shall be published with the implementing legislation. The Government Accountability Office shall review each major program at least once every ten years (Section 14.2.1).

27.11 Combined Tax Rate Disclosure [Statute]

Each edition of this platform, and each revenue bill implementing it, shall publish the combined top marginal rate on wages, pass-through income, and capital gains, counting income tax, Social

Security and Medicare contributions, Universal Health Insurance contributions, and the Extreme Wealth Fair-Share Tax.

27.12 Honest Limit

Dollar estimates are not yet included in this edition; the costing table is maintained in data/costing.csv and will be filled from published independent estimates. Wealth-tax and carbon revenues are deliberately kept away from recurring programs, so the recurring programs depend on the federal tax fairness measures. Those measures will be set out in their own chapter, and rates will follow independent scoring.

Conclusion

A New Social Contract

The purpose of this platform is neither to replace markets nor to leave every societal challenge to markets alone.

It rejects the false choice between centralized economic control and unrestricted laissez-faire governance.

America's greatest achievements have emerged when public institutions, private enterprise, scientific innovation, and civic participation worked together toward common goals.

The challenges of the twenty-first century demand that same approach.

This platform is built on the belief that prosperity, liberty, and fairness are not competing objectives. When designed intelligently, they reinforce one another.

The Role of Government

Government exists to perform the tasks that individuals and markets cannot effectively accomplish on their own.

Its responsibilities include:

- Protecting constitutional rights
- Maintaining democratic institutions
- Providing public infrastructure
- Ensuring public safety
- Expanding opportunity
- Supporting scientific research
- Preserving fair competition
- Maintaining national security

Government should be:

- Transparent
- Accountable
- Efficient
- Evidence-based
- Financially responsible

The measure of government is not how much it spends or how little it spends.

The measure of government is whether it successfully fulfills its responsibilities to the people.

The Role of Markets

Competitive markets remain the most effective system ever developed for:

- Innovation
- Entrepreneurship
- Investment
- Productivity
- Wealth creation

Markets encourage experimentation, reward success, and allow new ideas to compete with old ones.

This platform embraces private enterprise and free markets.

However, markets function best when:

- Competition exists
- Information is transparent
- Monopolies are restrained
- Workers possess bargaining power
- Consumers possess meaningful choice

The purpose of regulation is not to suppress markets.

The purpose of regulation is to keep markets functioning as markets.

The Value of Opportunity

The greatest resource in any nation is its people.

Economic success should not depend solely upon family wealth, geography, luck, or circumstance.

Every individual should have access to the tools necessary to reach their potential, including:

- Quality healthcare
- Excellent education
- Reliable infrastructure
- Safe communities
- Fair labor standards
- Affordable housing
- Access to opportunity

Opportunity cannot be guaranteed.

But access to opportunity can and should be.

A society that invests in its people invests in its future prosperity.

Science, Knowledge, and Progress

Science is humanity's pursuit of truth.

Every generation benefits from discoveries made by those who came before.

Scientific advancement has:

- Extended life expectancy
- Expanded economic prosperity
- Improved public health
- Increased agricultural productivity
- Enhanced national security
- Expanded human understanding

For this reason, scientific research, technological development, higher education, and exploration should be viewed as investments rather than expenses.

The pursuit of knowledge is both a practical necessity and a moral responsibility to future generations.

Democracy and Public Trust

Democracy depends upon trust.

Trust requires:

- Transparency
- Accountability
- Participation
- Ethical leadership

Citizens must be confident that:

- Elections are fair
- Institutions are honest
- Laws apply equally
- Public officials serve the public interest

Government legitimacy cannot be demanded.

It must be earned.

This platform therefore places special emphasis on democratic reform, anti-corruption measures, public accountability, and civic engagement.

Security Through Strength and Partnership

A secure nation requires more than military power.

Security also depends upon:

- Strong alliances
- Stable infrastructure
- Scientific leadership
- Economic resilience
- Secure supply chains
- Effective disaster preparedness

The United States should remain capable of defending itself and its allies while avoiding unnecessary conflicts and maintaining a strong commitment to diplomacy.

The strongest nations do not choose between strength and cooperation.

They possess both.

Responsibility to Future Generations

Every generation inherits institutions, infrastructure, resources, and freedoms built by those who came before.

Each generation also leaves something behind for those who follow.

This platform recognizes a responsibility to future generations by:

- Maintaining fiscal sustainability
- Protecting Social Security
- Investing in infrastructure
- Preserving environmental resources
- Supporting scientific research
- Strengthening democratic institutions
- Expanding economic opportunity

The purpose of public policy is not merely solving today's problems.

It is preparing the nation for tomorrow's opportunities.

Citizenship and Community

A free society depends upon more than government programs and economic systems.

It depends upon citizens who participate in their communities, contribute to the common good, and accept shared responsibility for the success of the nation.

Through voluntary service, civic engagement, local leadership, and community involvement, individuals strengthen the social fabric that supports democracy itself.

National strength begins at the community level.

Strong communities create a strong nation.

Our Commitment

We believe America can be:

- More prosperous without sacrificing fairness.
- More innovative without abandoning responsibility.
- More secure without sacrificing liberty.
- More competitive without tolerating monopoly power.
- More productive without abandoning working families.

- More diverse without losing national unity.
- More ambitious without sacrificing fiscal discipline.

We believe government can be effective without becoming overbearing.

We believe markets can be competitive without becoming exploitative.

We believe innovation can flourish while maintaining accountability.

We believe economic growth and human dignity can advance together.

Most importantly, we believe the future can be better than the present if institutions, businesses, communities, and citizens work together toward common goals.

Final Statement

This platform is founded on a simple principle:

Government provides the foundation. Citizens provide the ambition. Markets provide the growth.

A strong public foundation creates opportunity.

Free and competitive markets create prosperity.

Scientific progress expands what is possible.

Democratic institutions preserve accountability.

Communities provide belonging and purpose.

Together, they create a society that is prosperous, resilient, innovative, free, and just.

Build the foundation. Expand opportunity. Strengthen democracy. Invest in the future. Empower the people.

APPENDIX A: CONSTITUTIONAL AMENDMENTS REQUIRED

Purpose

Most policies contained within this platform may be enacted through federal legislation or executive action. Certain reforms, however, require amendment of the United States Constitution and therefore demand a substantially higher level of democratic consensus.

This appendix identifies all provisions within the platform that require constitutional amendment and summarizes their purpose.

The inclusion of a constitutional amendment proposal within this platform does not imply immediate enactment. Constitutional amendments should be pursued only through broad public support, democratic deliberation, and constitutional ratification procedures.

Amendment 1: Federal Service Age Limits

Related Provision

Section 12.6 - Age Limit of 68

Proposal

No person shall run for or hold federal elected office after reaching age 68, and federal judges shall retire at age 68.

Purpose

The purpose of this amendment is to:

- Promote leadership renewal
- Expand generational representation
- Encourage long-term institutional adaptability
- Ensure regular opportunities for new leadership

Guiding Principle

Democratic institutions should remain responsive to changing generations while preserving institutional knowledge and stability.

Amendment 2: Democratic Election Finance Reform

Related Provision

Section 12.7 - Campaign Finance & Anti-Corruption

Proposal

Congress and the States shall have the authority to establish reasonable limits on independent political expenditures and campaign financing while preserving:

- Freedom of speech
- Freedom of the press
- Freedom of association
- Legitimate issue advocacy

Purpose

The purpose of this amendment is to:

- Reduce undue financial influence in elections
- Increase public confidence in democratic institutions
- Strengthen political equality

- Enhance transparency and accountability

Guiding Principle

Political influence should derive primarily from citizens rather than the concentration of financial resources.

Future Constitutional Reform Considerations

The following subjects may warrant future national discussion but are not currently proposed as constitutional amendments within this platform:

- Electoral College reform
- Presidential term structure
- Expansion of voting rights protections
- Congressional representation reform
- Constitutional ethics requirements for federal officeholders
- Constitutional protection for the independence of federal investigations and prosecutions (pursued by statute in Section 15.11; an amendment would be considered only if courts reject that approach)

These issues would require additional public debate and are not incorporated as active amendment proposals within this edition of the platform.

Constitutional Amendment Principles

Constitutional amendments should satisfy the following standards:

Necessity

Amendments should be pursued only when statutory solutions are insufficient.

Democratic Legitimacy

Amendments should reflect broad and durable public support across political, geographic, and demographic boundaries.

Preservation of Liberty

No amendment should weaken fundamental constitutional rights, civil liberties, or democratic protections.

Institutional Stability

Amendments should strengthen the long-term effectiveness, legitimacy, and resilience of American constitutional government.

Constitutional Governance Statement

The Constitution of the United States provides the framework within which democratic self-government operates.

This platform seeks reform through constitutional processes, democratic consensus, and the rule of law.

Constitutional amendments should be rare, carefully considered, and adopted only when necessary to strengthen democratic accountability, equal opportunity, human dignity, and the long-term resilience of the Republic.

The Constitution establishes the framework. Democratic institutions provide accountability. Citizens provide legitimacy. Future generations inherit the results.

APPENDIX C: INSTITUTIONAL & REGULATORY DESIGN STANDARDS

Purpose

This appendix sets the design rules that every institution and regulation in the platform follows, so that rules, enforcement, and exemptions work the same way across sectors and remain legally durable.

Institutions After *Trump v. Slaughter*

In *Trump v. Slaughter* (2026), the Supreme Court held that Congress may not protect the heads of executive agencies from removal at will, with the Federal Reserve treated as an exception in *Trump v. Cook*. The Court left open protections for legislative-branch bodies and for inferior officers who report to accountable superiors.

The platform's rule is to **take discretion away rather than try to protect the person who exercises it**. Formulas, deadlines, and publication duties are written into statute, so an official who can be removed has little left to bend.

Five Durability Tools

Legislative-branch placement for advisory, scoring, and audit work (the Congressional Budget Office, the Joint Committee on Taxation, the Government Accountability Office, and advisory commissions modeled on MedPAC).

Formulas in statute: rates, thresholds, and investment mandates are set in law, and agencies apply and publish them.

Reasoned, public decisions: rejections and overrides must be published with written reasons, and removals of watchdog officials require written reasons and advance notice to Congress.

Protection for career staff: civil-service and inferior-officer protections, rather than protections for agency heads.

Courts and third parties: duties enforceable in federal court, independent outside evaluators, and Inspector General audits.

How Each Body Is Designed

Body

Section

Design

Health-payment advisory commission

5.1.3

Fee schedule set in statute. A legislative-branch commission recommends updates, which take effect unless HHS publishes a reasoned rejection

Rate appeals

5.1.4

Decided by administrative law judges

Dynamic Global Innovation Fund

5.2.2

Criteria and annual cap set in statute. Awards made through peer review that includes outside reviewers

Sovereign Wealth Reserve

1.3, 27.5

Statutory passive index mandate, private managers chosen by competitive bid, no voting rights. Draws only through the recession trigger

Social Security Endowment

26.4

Same passive mandate, reporting to the Social Security trustees

Independent costing

27.10

Congressional Budget Office and Joint Committee on Taxation

Ten-year program reviews

14.2.1

Government Accountability Office, supported by Inspectors General

Ethics enforcement

15.9

Congressional ethics office for Congress. For the executive branch, statutory duties enforced in court, Inspector General audits, and public disclosure

Inspectors General

15.6

Written reasons and 30 days' notice before removal. Acting Inspectors General drawn from career deputies

Justice Department independence

15.11

Contact logs, disclosure to Congress, and protections for career prosecutors

Sentencing review

16.4

The United States Sentencing Commission, in the judicial branch

Critical-supplies list

21.6.1

Recommended by a national-laboratory technical office using a published method. Issued by rule subject to congressional review

Frontier AI oversight

19.6

Commerce/NIST. Triggers and deadlines set in statute, independent evaluators, penalties enforced in court

Cross-Sector Regulatory Rules

Rule

Applies to

Standard

Dominance Threshold

8.1.3, 9.2, 10.1.5

Conduct-based rules. Extra duties apply only above one defined threshold, never based on size alone

Strategic Protection Test

11.2, 21.6.1, 21.8, 24.3

A documented need, a capped cost, a sunset date, and congressional authority for any tariff

Coordinated Review Standard

8.1.2, 20.6, 21.9

Faster permitting through staff, coordination, and timelines, never through weaker review

Pilot rule

14.5

Pilots only for untested program designs

Paperwork rule

14.2.5

One-in-one-out applies to paperwork and reporting burdens only

Honest limits

All High Resistance and Constitutionally Contested provisions

Each states its main legal or political risk

Still to come in later editions: a single definition of a small entity, with phased compliance, and a common enforcement ladder (disclosure, then civil penalties scaled to revenue, then court orders, then criminal penalties for willful violations).

APPENDIX D: SECTION MAP (v1.0 → v1.1)

Every section of the v1.0 platform and where it appears in the v1.1 structure. Sub-sections move with their parent (for example, v1.0 Section 3.2.4 is now 5.1.4). Generated from the restructuring map; see decision 0003 and the Phase 3 Master Architecture.

v1.0 section

v1.1 location

1.1

1.1

1.2

1.2

1.3

1.3

1.4

2.1

1.5

2.2

1.6

2.3

1.7

2.4

1.8

2.5

2.1

3.1

2.2

4.1

2.3

3.2

2.4

21.6.1 (now a subsection of the supply-chain program)

2.5

3.3

2.6

3.4

2.7

3.5

3.1

Part II introduction

3.2

5.1

3.3

5.2

3.4

5.3

3.5

7.1

3.6

7.2

3.7

7.3

3.8

21.4

3.9

9.3

3.10

9.4

3.11

8.1

3.12

6.1

4.1

9.1

4.2

9.2

4.3

10.1

5.1

11.1

5.2

11.2

6.1

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Part V introduction

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17.3.5 (merged into this subsection)

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16.6 (merged with old 10.6)

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Front matter: a one-page Platform Overview (replacing the embedded Executive Summary), Legal Classifications, Governing Principles (formerly Appendix A), and Definitions now precede Part I. The v1.0 Appendix B (Constitutional Amendments) is now Appendix A.